Year 11 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `Y11/Y11_Student_Paper_v3.1`. Year 11 joins the pack at version 3.1, so that every year group carries one version number: there is no earlier Year 11 paper. The core paper has the structure of Year 10 version 3.1, and two further booklets are given on the same day from their own documents: the **cognitive ability screen** (`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Y11_Y12`, guide `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide`) and the **optional sciences** (`Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_v3.1`, mark scheme `Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`). Do not mix papers and instructions from different years or versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y11_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

- **Listening** (16 marks): Part A is an everyday conversation at a sports centre; **Part B** is an academic talk at the level of a lesson (bamboo as a building material).
- **Reading** (16 marks): Part A is a web page of holiday workshops; Part B is the short story "Homing" (questions 8 to 14).
- **Maths** (30 marks): three sections that are scored separately: **Fluency** (10), **Word questions** (8) and **Applied problems** (12), at the level of the end of the first IGCSE Extended year. A scientific calculator is allowed in Section C only.
- **Science** (10 marks): IGCSE first-year biology, chemistry and physics, with one working-scientifically question.
- **Cognitive ability screen** and **optional sciences**: separate booklets (see Section 1). Their results are recorded on this year's grading sheet.

Who this is for. Students applying for **Year 11** (age 15 on 1 September), the **second year of a two-year IGCSE course**: they join courses that are already a year in. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 9 (初三)**, so all of junior high school and the zhongkao; a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 10 (高一). Some come from international or bilingual schools that teach IGCSE, and may have done part of Year 10 already. Ask the student and the family which grade, which school system and which textbooks they have used, because the order of topics differs. Background on Chinese school sequences, the English bands and the decision guide is in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

What it measures. English in listening, reading, writing and speaking (bands A to E); maths against the end of the first IGCSE Extended year, as three sub-scores (fluency, word questions, applied problems); core science at IGCSE first-year level; a reasoning profile (the cognitive screen); readiness for the sciences chosen (the optional sciences); and, through the interview, who the student is, their plans and their suitability. Section 6 explains how to read the results together to judge **readiness for joining the second year of IGCSE**.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
1	Welcome	2	Assessor		These instructions
2	Listening: Part A (questions 1 to 8) and Part B (questions 9 to 16), 16 marks	about 16 (the recording)	Assessor plays the recording, or reads both scripts (Section 3.1); a small group is fine	Student paper pages 2 to 5; pencil; the recording	Student paper; grading sheet
3	Reading paper: Parts A and B (16 marks)	15	Student works alone	Student paper pages 6 to 10	
4	Writing: one task from two (16 marks)	10	Student works alone	Student paper pages 11 to 12	
5	Break	5		Water	

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
6	Maths: Section A Fluency, Section B Word questions, Section C Applied problems (30 marks)	25	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 13 to 19; pencil, rubber, ruler; **no calculator in Sections A and B**; a **scientific calculator for Section C only** (from page 17)	A scientific calculator for each student
7	Core science: 6 questions (10 marks)	8	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 20 to 22; a calculator is allowed	
8	Break	5		Water	
9	**Cognitive ability screen**: three reasoning parts (12 items each) and processing speed (90 seconds); strict timing	25	Assessor, from `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide`; a small group is fine	`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Y11_Y12` booklet; pencil; a stopwatch; no calculator	The screen booklet; its guide (print once)
10	**Optional sciences**: Biology, Chemistry, Physics, 15 marks each; only those the student will take (a short break after two)	15 each	Assessor, from `Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`	`Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_v3.1` booklet; pencil, ruler, scientific calculator	The optional sciences booklet; its mark scheme (print once)
11	Interview, opening with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen at **Level 9**	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Sentence Reading Card (laminated); a plain card to cover sentences	Reading front sheet; Interview sheet for Years 11 and 12
	Total: core about 2 hours; with two optional sciences about 2 hours 35 minutes; with three about 2 hours 50 minutes	**about 121** (allow 125)		A clock or timer	Final mark sheet

A long day. The core paper, the break and the cognitive screen take about two hours. **The optional sciences and the interview may be given on a second visit** if the day is too long for the student or the timetable: arrange it with the family when the assessment is booked, and record on the grading sheet which parts were done on which day.

Marks go on the **grading sheet** (listening, writing, maths, core science, the optional sciences, the cognitive screen and readiness), the **Reading front sheet** (reading) and the **Interview sheet** (speaking).

For each candidate:

- the Year 11 student paper, version 3.1;
- the grading sheet (`Y11/Y11_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the cognitive ability screen booklet (`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Y11_Y12`);
- the optional sciences booklet (`Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_v3.1`), if the student takes any science;
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 11 and 12 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y11_Y12`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide` and `Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y11_Y12`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; laminate it);
- the other equipment in the table above: a clock or timer, a stopwatch, a plain card to cover the sentences, and a scientific calculator, pencil, rubber and ruler for each student.

The parent conversation (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`, about 15 minutes) runs alongside with another member of staff. The written papers (tasks 2 to 10) can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; the interview is

always 1:1.

2. Before you start

Room. Quiet, bright, a clock the student can see, the student paper face down, a pencil, rubber and ruler. Keep a scientific calculator for each student on your desk until they reach maths Section C. Glasses or hearing aids if the student uses them.

Say (welcome): "Hello, I am [name]. Thank you for coming today. These activities help us get to know you, so that we can help you when you join us. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets everything right, and that is fine. Do your best. If you do not know an answer, go on to the next question. Please write all your answers in English. In the English parts, I can only repeat the instructions. In maths and science, I can read any question to you. You can use a calculator only in the last section of the maths and in the science, and I will give it to you then. After this paper there is a short reasoning test, and then the science papers for the subjects you are choosing. Do you have any questions before we start?"

Pace of speech. Year 11 students may still be learning English: speak steadily and clearly, with a short pause after each sentence, when you give instructions, read the listening scripts and read maths and science questions aloud. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way (the Years 7 to 10 pace: the voice's normal speed, with about half a second after each sentence).

Access rules (the same in every year group, with the calculator rule for this paper)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not read the reading texts or questions aloud, explain words or translate. Instructions may be repeated in English.	Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as the student asks. You may point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Record the number of L questions on the grading sheet: it is evidence about English.
Answers	**All answers in English.** An answer in Chinese scores 0.	**All answers in English**: numbers, symbols, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0 (this includes the "Reason", "Show" and "Explain" answers).
Calculator	Not used.	Maths Sections A and B: **no calculator**. Maths Section C and science: a **scientific calculator**. The cognitive screen: no calculator (its guide).
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics on the grading sheet.

Extra time, a reader or other arrangements for a known need are allowed: record them on the grading sheet. The cognitive screen is strictly timed and has its own access rules (its guide): extra time is not given on the screen, but a known need is recorded beside its results.

Stopping rules

- The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Say: "That is fine. Thank you. We will go on to the next part."
- **Listening:** if the student scores 2 or fewer out of 8 in Part A (questions 1 to 8), you may leave out Part B: check Part A quickly in the minute after it. Say: "Thank you. That is the end of the listening." Record "Part B not given" on the grading sheet; the band then comes from Part A alone (band A). In a group, play Part B to everyone as usual; a student with 2 or fewer in Part A may sit quietly.
- **Reading paper:** if the student cannot answer any of Part A after about 4 minutes, let them stop and record it on the Reading front sheet. Do not move them on to Part B.

- **Writing:** if the student has written nothing in English after 3 minutes, say once: "Write anything you can in English: a few words or sentences about yourself is fine." Then let them stop when they wish.
- **Maths and science:** encourage the student to look at every page, because later questions on different topics may be easier for them. Do not stop early unless the student is distressed. Give the calculator when the student turns to Section C (page 17); in a group, give each student theirs when they reach that page. If a student goes back to Section A or B after that, take the calculator back while they work on it.
- **Cognitive screen and optional sciences:** follow the stopping rules in their own guides. A student who is tired after the core paper may take the optional sciences on a second visit (Section 1).
- If a student becomes upset at any point, stop, take a break, and continue only if they are happy to. Record it on the grading sheet.

Keeping the student at ease. Smile, use the student's name, and keep your voice calm. Do not say "right" or "wrong" during the tasks; say "thank you" instead. Give a two-minute warning before the end of the reading paper, maths and science. A student who finishes early may check their work quietly.

3. English

3.1 Listening (16 marks: Part A 8, Part B 8)

There are two parts, and each is played or read twice. **Part A** is an everyday conversation between a student and a receptionist at a sports centre: two voices. **Part B** is a short lesson-style talk by an engineer, with subject vocabulary, numbers, a correction and an implied opinion: the listening that IGCSE lessons need, at the level of a fluent speaker of 15 to 16.

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y11/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. If you read live, use the recording's pace (one reading of Part A takes about 2 minutes 7 seconds and of Part B about 3 minutes 6 seconds, with the pauses) and, for Part A, change your voice slightly for the two speakers. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script. Play Part A and Part B as separate tracks if you may stop after Part A; otherwise the full track plays both.

Part A. Say: "Turn to the Listening page. There are two parts. In Part A, you will hear a conversation between a student, Li Na, and a receptionist at a sports centre. You will hear it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 1 to 8." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Play or read the Part A script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Play or read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Part B. Say: "Now turn to Part B, on page 4. You will hear a talk by an engineer, Dr Lin Feng, about a building material. You will hear it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 9 to 16." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Play or read the Part B script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Play or read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Read both scripts twice at the steady pace in Section 2. At each [pause], stop for about 3 seconds. Do not slow down for key words, repeat sentences or explain anything. Read Part B at the same pace as Part A: it is meant to sound like a lesson.

Timing. The recording takes about 16 minutes: Part A about 7 minutes 6 seconds and Part B about 8 minutes 58 seconds, with one minute to read each set of questions, the 10-second gaps between the two readings and one minute to finish each part. **Allow about 16 minutes** for the listening.

Script, Part A: At the sports centre

Receptionist: Good afternoon. How can I help you?

Li Na: Hello. I'd like to join the swimming pool, please. I'm a student at Riverside School. [pause]

Receptionist: No problem. Do you just want to swim, or are you interested in the badminton courts and the running track as well? A full membership covers everything.

Li Na: Just the pool, thanks. I'm training for the school swimming team. [pause]

Receptionist: Then a pool membership is best. For students, it's one hundred and twenty yuan a month. Adults pay two hundred. You need to show me your student card today, and bring one passport photo for your membership card. We can take the photo here, but that costs twenty yuan. [pause]

Li Na: I've got my student card here. I'll bring a photo tomorrow. What are the opening times?

Receptionist: Monday to Friday, we open at six thirty in the morning and close at nine at night. At the weekend, we open at seven and close at eight. The pool is closed on Wednesday mornings for cleaning, until twelve o'clock. [pause]

Li Na: And how big is the pool?

Receptionist: It's twenty-five metres long, with eight lanes. In the evenings, after five o'clock, two lanes are kept for lessons, so there are only six for everyone else, and it gets very busy. If you want a quiet lane, come before school. [pause]

Li Na: Before school? Oh no. I'd better set an alarm. [pause]

Receptionist: One more thing. On Tuesday evenings, from seven until eight, there's a session with a coach. It's free for members. Most of the people who come are training for competitions. The coach watches how you swim and tells you what to change.

Li Na: That sounds perfect. Thank you very much. [pause]

Part A answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the meaning is clear.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**A** (swimming)		B or C: the receptionist mentions badminton and the running track, but Li Na says "Just the pool".
2	**Wednesday mornings**		Monday (not said); Sunday evenings (the weekend closing time is 8, but the pool is not closed for cleaning then).
3	**B** (a photo)		A (the student card: she has it and shows it today); C (not said).
4	**120**	one hundred and twenty	200 (the adult price); 20 (the cost of a photo).
5	**6**	six	8 (the total number of lanes); 2 (the lanes kept for lessons).
6	**7:00**	7; seven; 7 am; seven o'clock	6:30 (Monday to Friday); 8 (closing time); 12 (the end of cleaning).
7	**Because she will have to get up (very) early to swim before school**	the quiet time is before school, so she must wake up early; she is not used to getting up early	"Because she wants to swim" with no idea of early; "because the pool is busy" (the cause, but not why an alarm).

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
8	**Because Li Na is training for the team, and the coach can help her swim better (improve her technique)**	it is for people training for competitions, like her; it is free for members and useful for her training	"Because it is on Tuesday"; "because it is free" alone (true, but not why it is relevant to her).

Script, Part B: a talk about bamboo

Good morning. My name is Dr Lin Feng, and I'm a structural engineer. That means I work out how to make buildings stand up. Today I want to talk about bamboo. [pause]

The first thing to understand is that bamboo is not a tree. It's a grass, a very large one. A tree adds a thin ring of wood each year, so a hardwood tree may take forty years or more to reach its full size. Bamboo, on the other hand, sends up a new shoot that reaches its full height in a single growing season of a few months. After that, the pole doesn't grow any taller; it simply hardens. The pole is called a culm, and it is hollow, divided into sections by solid walls called nodes. The nodes are what give the pole its strength: without them, it would fold like a drinking straw. [pause]

That hardening takes time. A culm can be cut after two years. Actually, let me correct that: two years is too young, because the fibres are still soft. For building, we wait at least four years. The poles are then treated, because insects love fresh bamboo. First, the cut poles are soaked in a salt solution for about a week, which drives the sugars out of the fibres. Second, they are dried slowly in the shade for two months; dried too fast in the sun, they crack. [pause]

How strong is bamboo? In our laboratory we measure tensile strength, which simply means how hard you can pull on a material before it breaks. Weight for weight, the treated bamboo we tested was about as strong in tension as mild steel, and far stronger than the pine used in most timber frames. However, a bamboo pole is weak where you join it to another pole, because a bolt through a hollow tube cracks the wall. As a result, most of the engineering in a bamboo building is in the joints, not in the poles. [pause]

In 2022, my team designed a sports hall for a school in Guangxi, using bamboo for the whole roof. The frame cost about a third less than a steel frame would have cost, and it was built by local workers in eleven weeks. Growing the bamboo took carbon dioxide out of the air, whereas making a tonne of steel releases nearly two tonnes of it. [pause]

I should be honest about the drawbacks. Bamboo rots if it stays wet, so the roof must keep it dry. Poles are not all the same size, so every joint has to be measured by hand. And some architects still call bamboo "the poor man's timber". I notice that the same architects are quite happy to be photographed in front of our hall. [pause]

Your school is planning a new bicycle shelter. I'm not going to tell you what it should be made of. But I'd like you to ask the question. Thank you. [pause]

Part B answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the word is recognisable and the meaning is clear. Every answer is said in the script, and the questions follow the order of the script.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Specific detail (a number), after a correction	**4** (years)	four; at least four; 4 or more	**2**: the number he corrects ("Actually, let me correct that"). An answer of 2 shows the student caught the first number but not the correction. 40 (the tree) shows the comparison was not followed.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
10	Note completion (a process)	**salt solution**	salt water; a solution of salt; salty water; recognisable spellings (solt solution)	"water" alone (not enough: the salt is the point); "a week"; "the shade" (the second step).
11	Note completion (a process)	**shade**	the shade; shadow; out of the sun; recognisable spellings	"sun" (the opposite: dried in the sun they crack); "two months" (already in the note).
12	Subject vocabulary explained in context	**B**: how hard you can pull a material before it breaks		A (weight is the comparison, not the measure); C and D (not said).
13	Specific detail (a number)	**11**	eleven	2022 (the year); 2 (months of drying, or tonnes); a third (the saving).
14	Inference joining two parts of the talk	**Two reasons: (1) the poles are hollow, so a bolt through the wall cracks it (the joint is the weak point); (2) the poles are not all the same size, so every joint has to be measured by hand.**	Either reason in other words: "a hollow tube cracks when you bolt it"; "the poles are different sizes, so the joints cannot all be the same"; "the pole is strong but the joint is weak".	One reason only: 0 (the question asks for two and joins the strength paragraph with the drawbacks paragraph). "Because bamboo is a grass" or "because it rots" (true, but not about joints).
15	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**B**: he thinks they criticise bamboo but are happy to be seen with his building		A is the opposite of his view; C and D are not said. He never says the architects are wrong: the student must hear the irony in "the same architects are quite happy to be photographed in front of our hall".
16	Main idea or speaker's purpose	**B**: to explain how bamboo is used in buildings and make students think about it		A goes too far (he says "I'm not going to tell you what it should be made of"); C is one part of the talk; D exaggerates one sentence. The ending ("I'd like you to ask the question") carries the purpose.

What is in the Part B script (for the English team): about 480 words in 35 sentences (about 14 words a sentence on average); about 21% of the running words are outside the 2000 most common English words (about 29% of the distinct words; `wordfreq` lists, names left out). It uses subject vocabulary explained in context (structural engineer, culm, node, tensile strength, mild steel, timber frame). It explains a process (how a culm grows and hardens; how poles are treated) and a cause and effect (why the joints matter; why steel costs carbon); compares a tree with bamboo, bamboo with steel and pine, and a bamboo frame with a steel one; gives numbers and a date; corrects a number ("Actually, let me correct that"); implies opinions without stating them (the architects, the bicycle shelter); and uses discourse markers (on the other hand, first, second, however, as a result, whereas).

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A** New to English
Part A 3 to 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C** Developing competence
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

If the two parts disagree in an unexpected way (for example Part A 5 or 6 with Part B 5 or more), use the interview to decide: the student may have lost easy marks in Part A through nerves or carelessness.

What to look for

- **Part A** checks everyday listening with two voices: questions 1 to 3 the main points, 4 to 6 exact details with distractors (200, 8 lanes, 6:30), and 7 and 8 implied meaning and the speaker's purpose.
- **Part B** is the step up. Questions 9 to 13 need exact detail from fast, connected speech, with distractors (2 years, the sun, 2022); questions 14 to 16 need the student to join ideas across the talk, hear an attitude that is never stated and see the purpose of the whole talk. A student who gets 9 to 13 but not 14 to 16 follows the content of a lesson but not yet its argument.
- **Part A secure, Part B 0 to 2**: everyday English is fine, but lessons taught only by talk will be hard to follow at first. In Year 11 there is less time to adjust than in Year 10: plan visual support, key vocabulary in writing and frequent checks for understanding from the first week.
- Compare with listening in the interview. If the two differ by more than one band, use the interview as a check.

3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading page. There are two parts, A and B. Part B is harder. Read the texts yourself. I cannot read them to you or explain words. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 15 minutes." Give a two-minute warning.

General rules. Answers can be in the student's own words or copied from the text, unless the question says "copy" or "in your own words". Ignore spelling and grammar unless the answer cannot be understood. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: a web page of holiday workshops (very accessible; picture support)

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
1	10:00	1	10; 10 am; ten o'clock. Do not accept 12:30 (the end) or 9:30 (Photography).
2	Robotics; First aid	2	1 mark for each correct tick, minus 1 for each wrong tick (minimum 0).
3	First aid	1	The only workshop for ages 15 and over. Do not accept Robotics (14+: he can join) or Photography (full, but he could join the waiting list; the question asks about age).
4	¥25	1	25; 25 yuan (half of ¥50 with a student card). Do not accept 50 (the half-price note missed).
5	Borrow a camera from the centre (for ¥20)	1	borrow one; rent a camera for 20 yuan. Do not accept "buy a camera" or "join another workshop".
6	Friday 20 June	1	20 June; 20th June. Do not accept "Friday" alone or "Monday" (the first workshop).
7	Add your name to the waiting list (and the centre will email you if a place becomes free)	1	join the waiting list; wait for an email. Do not accept "book online" or "call them".

Part B: "Homing" (a short story, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 15; questions 8 to 14)

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
8	Retrieval	Her parents are both working through the summer	1	her parents are busy working; they have to work. Do not accept "because she likes pigeons".
9	Vocabulary in context	without wanting to	1	

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
10	Retrieval with evidence	Any two of: the town has only one shop; one bridge; "no wifi worth the name" (no good wifi); she "counted the days" (accept, although it is in the second paragraph: it shows the same thing)	2	1 mark each, maximum 2. Do not accept "she had not wanted to come" alone (that is her feeling, not a detail about the town) or "her parents were working".
11	Inference (character)	He wants her to see for herself: the answer is to wait and watch; or he is a man of few words and does not explain things; or nobody really knows how pigeons find their way, so he cannot answer	1	Any sensible inference linked to the text (he "was not a talker"; he answers "with a look"; he looks "at the sky"). Do not accept "he did not hear her" or "he is angry".
12	Inference (change in a character)	She has become interested in the birds, or absorbed in whether they will come back; the annoyance has gone; nothing in the town matters compared with the sky	1	"she cares now"; "she is waiting for the pigeons"; "she has stopped being bored". Do not accept "she likes the sky" or "the sky is beautiful".
13	Inference from a comparison	He is calm and not worried; he trusts the bird to come back; he has experience, so a late bird is normal to him	1	"he is patient"; "he is sure it will come". Do not accept "he does not care about the bird" (he counts them and names it).
14	Writer's purpose (structure)	It shows that Chen Yu now wants to go again (her attitude has reversed): she asks the time herself, without being told, after "counting the days" at the start; the ending leaves the reader to notice the change rather than stating it	1	"she is keen now"; "it is the opposite of the beginning"; "it shows she has changed her mind"; "it is a surprise ending that makes you think". Do not accept "because the story is finished" or "because he said tomorrow".

Band guide (version 3.1; use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 3	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 3 to 5	**C** Developing competence
Part B 6 to 8	**D** Competent, or **E** Fluent (see below)

D or E. Part B is the age-level text, so 6 or more shows at least a competent reader. Give **E** only when Part B is 7 or 8 **and** the sentence reading screen (meaning checks and fluency) and the writing also point to E. There is no text above age level on this paper, so the reading paper alone cannot confirm band E.

Record the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes on the **Reading front sheet**, and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- **Part B** is a literary text: the meaning is carried by what characters do and do not say, not by statements. A student who answers 8, 9 and 10 (retrieval and vocabulary) but not 11 to 14 reads the words but not yet the story: inference in fiction is what IGCSE English (First Language or Literature) and the longer texts in other subjects demand.
- **Strong readers** give the change in Chen Yu in their own words (12 and 14) and explain the grandfather from his behaviour (11 and 13). Copying a line that is in the right place but does not answer the question is the commonest sign of a band D reader.
- **An English barrier** looks like: Part A secure, Part B patchy or copied lines. A student who reads aloud well (sentence reading) but scores low on Part B may be decoding without understanding: see the meaning checks on the Reading front sheet.
- **Speed.** Note where the student was when time ran out, on the Reading front sheet. IGCSE papers are long; a student who is accurate but very slow will need reading practice and, possibly, an access arrangement assessment if there is a specific need.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task, A or B, and tick the box. You can plan in the box, then write on the lines. You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can." Do not explain the tasks or words.

The tasks. Task A (narrative): a story that begins "The box had been in the cupboard for as long as anyone could remember." Task B (discursive): an essay for the English teacher on whether every school should make its students do at least one hour of sport every day, with an opinion, reasons, examples and an answer to the other side. The plan is not marked.

Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 fall between the descriptions).

Criterion	0	2	4 (what a fluent 15 year old would do)
Content and organisation	Nothing relevant in English, or a few words copied from the task.	Relevant to the task; ideas in a sensible order but little developed; may be one block of text; the story is a list of events, or the essay lists reasons without explaining them and ignores the other side.	Well developed and clearly organised in paragraphs. Story: a shape (a build-up, a turning point, an ending that means something), a character the reader can picture, detail chosen for effect. Essay: a clear position, reasons developed with examples, the other side stated and answered, a conclusion; written for a teacher.
Vocabulary	Isolated words, or only words from the prompt.	Everyday words used correctly but repeated ("very", "good", "many people"); a few words chosen for effect; simple linking (and, but, because).	Wide and precise vocabulary chosen for effect (verbs of movement and feeling in the story; words of argument such as benefit, pressure, balance in the essay); a range of linking words (however, moreover, although, as a result); some figurative language that works.
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Mostly simple sentences, some joined with and, but, because; frequent errors in verb forms, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear.	A variety of sentence types used for effect, including complex sentences and some short sentences for impact; tenses controlled (the story stays in the past; the essay handles conditionals: "if schools did this, ..."); errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Mostly impossible to read.	Common words spelt correctly; capital letters and full stops mostly correct; errors in less common words.	Almost all words spelt correctly, including ambitious ones; a range of punctuation (speech marks in the story, commas after openers, apostrophes, colons, question marks) used correctly.

Band by best fit, using the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and the notes below. The total is a check, not a rule: as a rough guide, totals of 0 to 3 usually go with A, 4 to 7 with B, 8 to 10 with C, 11 to 13 with D and 14 to 16 with E.

Band	Writing at Year 11 entry
A	Name, isolated words or copied phrases; may write in Chinese.
B	A few short sentences on the topic, with frequent errors; meaning mostly clear.
C	A short connected piece (often 70 to 130 words) with some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; little paragraphing.
D	An organised piece (often 130 to 220 words) with paragraphs and a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; some varied vocabulary; the essay gives reasons but may not answer the other side.
E	See below.

Band E writing at this age. A fluent 15 year old usually writes 200 to 300 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with controlled, varied sentences, precise vocabulary chosen for its effect on the reader, and accurate spelling and punctuation. The story has a shape and an ending that means something, rather than stopping; the essay argues, gives evidence and examples, states the other side and answers it. This is roughly the level a First Language English IGCSE course expects in its second year.

What to look for

- Typical features of English from speakers of Chinese (missing articles, plural -s, past tense -ed, third person -s) are normal at bands C and D. Do not let them alone pull a well-organised, well-developed piece below D.
- A memorised opening ("Nowadays, with the development of society") or memorised essay phrases followed by very simple writing shows exam training more than fluency: band by what the student can produce independently.
- In Year 11 the student will sit IGCSE writing within about 18 months, in almost every subject. If writing is two bands below reading or listening, name it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet: it is the first thing the support plan must address.

3.4 Interview, speaking and sentence reading (15 minutes, 1:1)

The questions and the speaking band descriptors are in the **Interviewer guide for Years 11 and 12** (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y11_Y12`), and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y11_Y12`). The sentence reading rules are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`, the student reads from `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, and the results go on the **Reading front sheet**. All are in English.

- **Sentence reading first** (3 to 5 minutes). Year 11 starts at **Level 9 (sentence 25)**, the top start level. Follow the start, going-back and stopping rules and the scoring in the guide. It gives total points out of 72, an indicative reading age, meaning checks and a fluency rating, which you record on the Reading front sheet. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1.
- **Interview** (about 10 minutes): choose questions from each block in the Interviewer guide, including **subject choices and why**, **university plans**, **independent study and workload**, what the student knows about IGCSE, and the **Year 11 only** question: whether the student understands that they are joining courses a year in, and what they will do to catch up. Use the easier and stretch prompts so that every student can show their best spoken English. Ask the questions at the pace in Section 2, the same for every candidate.
- **Speaking band:** give it using the descriptors in the Interviewer guide, and record it on the Interview sheet. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths page. You have 25 minutes. There are three sections. In Sections A and B, you may not use a calculator. When you get to Section C, on page 17, I will give you a calculator. Write your answers in the boxes and show your working. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can, and look at every page."

The example box at the start of Section A shows what the command words and phrases mean (simplify fully, surd form, "in the form $(x + a)^2 + b$", turning point, the nth term); the example at the start of Section B shows what "Write an equation, then solve it" means. They are there so that an English phrase does not hide maths the student can do.

Section	Questions	Marks	Calculator	What it measures
A Fluency	1 to 6	10	No	Algebra and number at the end of the first IGCSE Extended year, with no context: fractional indices, surds, completing the square, factorising with $a \neq 1$, the nth term of a quadratic sequence, simultaneous equations with one quadratic. Demanding on purpose: these students usually find routine algebra easy.
B Word questions	7 to 10	8	No	Maths given only in sentences, with no diagram: the student must read, decide what to do and, usually, form an equation. Inverse proportion, a quadratic from consecutive numbers, probability without replacement, and a speed problem that gives a linear equation.
C Applied problems	11 to 16	12	Scientific	Multi-step problems in real contexts with a graph, a diagram or a table: a cumulative frequency graph, a volume scale factor, circle theorems with a reason, trigonometry, the quadratic formula in a context, and compound against simple interest. Questions 13 and 16 ask the student to give a reason or show a decision.

Calculator. Section C and science only. Before question 14, check that the calculator shows D or DEG (degrees). Many students from Chinese schools rarely use a calculator in maths lessons, so note how fluently they use one

(powers, sin, the quadratic formula) in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet: IGCSE calculator papers need it.

Marking. M = method mark, A = accuracy mark (depends on the method), B = independent mark. A correct answer with no working gets full marks unless the scheme says otherwise: in questions 8 and 10 (which ask for an equation) a correct answer with no equation scores 1, in question 13(b) an angle with no reason scores 0, and in question 16 a tick with no figures scores 0. Units are not needed unless stated. Working in numbers and symbols is fine; any words must be in English (a reason written in Chinese scores 0, but the figures beside it still count).

What a Year 11 entrant may not have been taught. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed **Grade 9 (初三)**, so **algebra, quadratics and geometry are usually strengths**: by the zhongkao most have done factorising, surds, quadratic equations by factorising, completing the square and the formula (一元二次方程), quadratic functions and their vertex (二次函数), inverse proportion (反比例函数), similarity (相似), acute-angle trigonometry (锐角三角函数), circle theorems (圆周角, 圆内接四边形) and probability with tree diagrams (概率). Some content on this paper is senior high school (高一) or not in the Chinese course at all, so it **may not have been taught** even to a strong student: fractional indices (高一), the nth term of a quadratic sequence (sequences are 高二), cumulative frequency, volume scale factors of similar solids, and calculator trigonometry with non-special angles. Use NT and judge whether the student would reach the expected band once taught: a strong Grade 9 student usually learns these quickly. A student from a school that teaches IGCSE should have met all of it.

Section A: Fluency (no calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Fractional indices with an algebraic base	$8x^6$	B1. An answer of $12x^6$ ($16 \times 3/4$) or $8x^{11}$ (the index added) scores 0: note which.	Fractional indices are 高一: may not have been taught. A student who sees $16 = 2^4$ may still reason it out.
2	Surds: expanding a bracket	$11 - 6\sqrt{2}$ ($a = 11$, $b = -6$)	B1. An answer of $9 - 2 = 7$ or $11 - 3\sqrt{2}$ means the middle term was lost or halved: the expansion of a square is not secure.	Secure (Grade 8, 二次根式).
3	Completing the square; the turning point	(a) $(x - 4)^2 - 13$ (b) $(4, -13)$	(a) B1. (b) B1, follow through from a correct form in (a) with a wrong b. An answer of $(-4, -13)$ or $(4, 13)$ means the sign is misread from the form: the method is there, the reading of it is not.	配方法 and the vertex form (顶点式) are Grade 9, so the algebra is familiar; the English ("in the form", "turning point") is the barrier (both are in the example box).
4	Factorising with $a \neq 1$	$x = 1/3$ or $x = -2$	M1 for $(3x - 1)(x + 2)$; A1 for both solutions. Correct solutions by the formula score M1 A1 (the question says "by factorising", but the solutions are right); solutions with no working score B1 only. Sign errors such as $x = -1/3$ and 2 are M1 A0.	Secure (Grade 9, 一元二次方程, 十字相乘法 in most textbooks).
5	The nth term of a quadratic sequence	$2n^2 + n + 2$	M1 for the second difference 4 and $2n^2$, or for subtracting $2n^2$ to get 3, 4, 5, 6, 7; A1 for $2n^2 + n + 2$. Accept an equivalent form. A linear answer ($7n - 2$, which fits only the first two terms) scores 0.	Not in the Chinese course as a method: may not have been taught. Pattern questions (找规律) are familiar, so a strong student may find the rule by trial: full marks if it is right.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
6	Simultaneous equations, one linear and one quadratic	$x = 2$, $y = 5$ or $x = -5$, $y = -2$	M1 for substituting to get a correct quadratic, $x^2 + 3x - 10 = 0$ (or $2x^2 + 6x - 20 = 0$); A1 for both pairs. One pair only: M1 A0. Pairs mismatched ($x = 2$ with $y = -2$) score M1 A0.	Substitution and quadratics are Grade 7 and 9; the pairing is less common in Chinese textbooks, but a strong student usually sees what to do.

Section B: Word questions (no calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
7	Inverse proportion (to a square), from a sentence	1 (unit)	M1 for $y = k/x^2$ with $k = 36$ (or brightness × distance^2 = 36), or for "3 times the distance, so 1/9 of the brightness"; A1 for 1. An answer of 3 (inverse proportion without the square) or 81 (direct proportion to the square) scores 0: the English of "inversely" or "the square" was lost.	Inverse proportion is Grade 9 (反比例函数) and the physics idea is familiar. The sentence is the barrier: read it aloud if it is blank.
8	Forming and solving a quadratic from consecutive even numbers	12 and 14, or −14 and −12	M1 for a correct equation in one unknown, $n(n + 2) = 168$ or $n^2 + 2n - 168 = 0$ (or $2m(2m + 2) = 168$); A1 for both pairs. One pair (12 and 14) with the equation: M1 A0. 12 and 14 with no equation: 1 mark. "Consecutive even numbers" written as n and $n + 1$ gives no integer solution: 0, and it shows the English of "even" was lost.	Secure (Grade 9, 一元二次方程的应用).
9	Probability without replacement, from a sentence	15/28	M1 for 5/8 × 3/7 or 3/8 × 5/7 (= 15/56), or for 1 − (5/8 × 4/7 + 3/8 × 2/7); A1 for 15/28. Accept 30/56, 0.536 (0.54 or better) or 53.6%. 15/56 alone (one order only) is M1 A0. 30/64 (with replacement) scores 0: the student missed "keeps it".	Secure (Grade 9, 概率, 不放回 with a tree diagram); the sentence form is the test.
10	A linear equation from a speed context	6 km	M1 for $d/15 - d/20 = 6/60$ (or an equivalent, for example in minutes: $60d/15 - 60d/20 = 6$, or $4d - 3d = 6$), or for the two times differing by 6 minutes with a correct expression for each; A1 for 6. An answer of 2 km (from "4 − 2") or an equation with 2 minutes instead of 6 (the difference between late and early not seen) scores 0. 6 with no equation: 1 mark.	Secure maths: a classic 行程问题 from Grade 7. If it is wrong, the English is the likely barrier: read it aloud.

Section C: Applied problems (scientific calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
11	Cumulative frequency graph	(a) 42 marks (b) 12 students	(a) B1 for 41 to 44 (read at cumulative frequency 40; the exact reading is 42.2). An answer of 40 (the cumulative frequency itself) or 36 (read at 40 marks) scores 0. (b) B1 for 10 to 14 (80 − 68 = 12). An answer of 68 (the students who scored 60 or less) scores 0: "more than" was lost.	Not taught in Chinese middle school (频数分布 is, cumulative curves are not): may not have been taught. Note NT and look at the reading.
12	Similar solids: volume scale factor	32 000 litres	M1 for the length scale factor 40 (1200 ÷ 30) and 40^3 = 64 000, or for "volume factor = (length factor) cubed"; A1 for 32 000 (accept 32 m^3). Using the length factor (0.5 × 40 = 20 litres) or the area factor (0.5 × 1600 = 800 litres) scores 0: this is the error the question is designed to find. Mixing units (12 ÷ 30 = 0.4) scores 0.	Similarity and area factors are Grade 9 (相似图形的面积比); volume factors of similar solids are not usually taught.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
13	Circle theorems with a reason	(a) 68° (b) 112°, because opposite angles of a cyclic quadrilateral add up to 180°	(a) B1 (the angle at the centre is twice the angle at the circumference). (b) B1 for 112° **with** a correct reason in English: "opposite angles of a cyclic quadrilateral add up to 180°" or "angles in the same segment / the other side of the circle: 180 − 68". 112° with no reason, or with a wrong reason, scores 0 for (b): the reason is the point. Accept (b) follow through: 180 − (a). An answer of 224° (the reflex angle at the centre) in (b) scores 0.	Secure (Grade 9, 圆周角定理, 圆内接四边形). The reason in English is the new demand: "cyclic quadrilateral" or "opposite angles 180" has it.
14	Trigonometry in a right-angled triangle, with a calculator	L = 17.0 m	M1 for sin 32° = 9/L or L = 9/sin 32°; A1 for 17.0 (accept 16.98 to 17.0). 9 × sin 32° = 4.77 (the ratio inverted) scores 0. 9/tan 32° = 14.4 is the horizontal distance: M0. sin 32 = 0.55 means the calculator is in radians: note it. 9/cos 32° = 10.6 confuses the sides: M0.	Grade 9 trigonometry (锐角三角函数) uses special angles without a calculator; sin 32° with a calculator may be new. sin 32° = 9/L unfinished shows the maths: M1, and note the calculator.
15	The quadratic formula in a context	t = 0.74 s and t = 3.26 s	M1 for $5t^2 - 20t + 12 = 0$ (or $20t - 5t^2 = 12$) and the formula or completing the square applied; A1 for 0.74 and 3.26 (accept 0.73 or 0.74, and 3.26 or 3.27). One correct time only: M1 A0. Solving $20t - 5t^2 = 0$ (t = 0 and 4: when the ball is on the ground) scores 0: the 12 m was not used.	Secure (Grade 9, 公式法); the equation is given. Decimal answers with a calculator are the IGCSE habit to look for.
16	Compound and simple interest (Show)	Wang Hao (by about ¥3.63)	M1 for $5000 \times 1.03^5 = 5796.37$ (accept 5796 to 5797), or for 5000 + 5 × 160 = 5800; A1 for both totals and "Wang Hao". Accept the comparison of interest only (796.37 against 800). Li Na's account treated as simple interest (5000 + 5 × 150 = 5750, so Wang Hao) is M0 A0: the conclusion is right for the wrong reason. Compound interest found but no comparison made: M1 A0. A tick with no figures: 0.	Compound growth is Grade 9 (增长率) and simple interest is primary school (利息): usually secure. Two correct totals and a tick is enough.

Sub-scores and total: Fluency (questions 1 to 6) / 10; Word questions (7 to 10) / 8; Applied (11 to 16) / 12; total / 30.

Band guide (provisional, for a paper at the end of the first IGCSE Extended year; review after the first 20 to 30 candidates): 0 to 10 (under 35%): **1** Below expected; 11 to 16 (35 to 54%): **2** Working towards; 17 to 22 (55 to 74%): **3** Expected; 23 to 30 (75% or more): **4** Greater depth, likely top set.

Not tested (not enough time): algebraic fractions, functions (composite and inverse), inequalities, direct proportion, probability with replacement, bearings and upper and lower bounds. Ask about them in the interview if they matter for setting; functions and bounds are also the topics a Year 11 entrant from a Chinese school is least likely to have met.

Reading the three sub-scores

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency high (7 or more out of 10), **word questions low** (3 or less out of 8)	The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier.	Read the word questions aloud in English and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (mark L). If the student then solves them, record "English barrier in maths" on the grading sheet. This student needs maths vocabulary and practice in reading problems, not a lower tier.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency and word questions high, **applied low** (5 or less out of 12)	The student calculates and sets up equations well but is less practised in multi-step problems in context, reading graphs, choosing a method and giving a reason. Check the NT topics first: questions 11, 12 and 14 include content outside the Chinese course.	Teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. Practice with "show that", "give a reason" and graph-reading questions, which fill the IGCSE Extended papers.
All three high (band 4)	A strong mathematician who can read and apply.	Extended tier; likely top set.
Fluency low, word questions and applied higher	Unusual for a student from a Chinese mainstream school; more common from a bilingual or international school where formal algebra comes later.	Check which algebra has been taught. The Extended tier may still fit, with an algebra catch-up plan and a review after one term.
All three low, not explained by NT or L	Gaps in earlier learning, or a possible learning need. Read with the cognitive screen (its guide, Section 9).	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).

What to look for

- **Strong responses** show organised working, correct notation and decisions backed by figures (questions 13 and 16), use the calculator fluently in Section C, and attempt the IGCSE topics (cumulative frequency, volume factors) even when they are new.
- **A correct answer with no reason** (question 13(b)) or **a tick with no figures** (question 16) is common from students used to answer-only questions. It scores 0, but it is a habit that can be taught quickly, not a gap in maths: note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- **English or maths?** Question 10 is maths that almost every Chinese-school student knows well (a speed problem). If it is wrong or blank but the student solves it once it is read aloud, the barrier is English. The same check works for questions 7 to 9.
- **Weak responses** show errors on taught topics (questions 2, 3, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 13 and 15), not just on NT topics. If most of the lost marks are NT questions (1, 5, 11, 12 and the calculator in 14), write the likely band once taught in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science page. You have 8 minutes. You may use your calculator. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can."

What a Year 11 entrant may not have been taught. A student who has completed Grade 9 in a Chinese school has done biology (Grades 7 and 8), physics (Grades 8 and 9, including electricity and magnetism) and one year of chemistry (Grade 9: atoms, the periodic table, formulae, conservation of mass, acids and bases; the mole is not taught). So most of this paper is familiar content; the new demands are the English of the questions and the working-scientifically question (6). A student from an IGCSE school should have met everything here in Year 10.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Gas exchange and respiration (data in a table)	(a) Carbon dioxide (b) Oxygen is used by the cells in (aerobic) respiration	(a) B1: carbon dioxide; CO_2. Do not accept oxygen or nitrogen. (b) B1: oxygen is used (taken in by the blood, absorbed in the lungs) for respiration, or to release energy in the cells. "Because we breathe it in" or "because the body needs it" alone is not enough: the answer must say what the oxygen is used for.	Secure (Grade 7 biology, 呼吸作用 and 呼吸系统).

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
2	Relative formula mass; conservation of mass	(a) 100 (b) 44 g	(a) B1: 40 + 12 + 48. An answer of 68 (one oxygen) or 52 (the oxygen left out) scores 0. (b) B1: 100 – 56 = 44. Accept 44 from the formula mass of CO_2 (12 + 32) with no subtraction: the reasoning is sound. An answer of 56 or 100 scores 0.	Secure (Grade 9 chemistry, 相对分子质量 and 质量守恒定律). The mole is not needed.
3	Specific heat capacity	42 000 J	B1 for 0.5 × 4200 × 20 = 42 000. Accept 42 kJ. An answer of 84 000 (ΔT taken as 40) or 21 000 scores 0.	Secure (Grade 9 physics, 比热容, $Q = cm\Delta t$); the equation is also printed.
4	Hooke's law from a table	10 cm	B1. Accept 10.0. An answer of 7.5 (the table copied) or 2.5 (the extension per newton) scores 0.	Secure (Grade 8 physics, 弹簧测力计: extension proportional to load), although the name "Hooke's law" may be new.
5	Moments (the principle of the lever)	300 N	B1 for 400 × 1.5 ÷ 2 = 300. An answer of 533 (400 × 2 ÷ 1.5) scores 0: the distances were swapped.	Secure (Grade 8 physics, 杠杆平衡条件).
6	Osmosis investigation: pattern, variables, improving a method	(a) The higher the sugar concentration, the smaller the gain in mass, then the greater the loss (or: the mass change goes from a gain to a loss as the concentration rises) (b) One control variable (c) One sensible change to the method	(a) B1: must link both variables; "as the concentration increases, the change in mass decreases (becomes more negative)" is fine. "The potato loses mass" alone is 0. (b) B1: the size, mass or shape of the potato pieces; the time in the solution; the temperature; the volume of solution; the same potato. Do not accept "the concentration" (the independent variable) or "the mass change" (the dependent variable). (c) B1: test more concentrations between 5% and 10% (smaller steps, for example 6%, 7%, 8%, 9%); or plot a graph of mass change against concentration and read where the line crosses zero. "Repeat the experiment" alone is not enough: it improves reliability, not the resolution the question asks for.	Osmosis as a word is IGCSE; the idea (植物细胞的吸水和失水) is Grade 7 biology. Designing and evaluating a method is less familiar in Chinese schools: score what the student writes.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 3: **1**; 4 to 5: **2**; 6 to 8: **3**; 9 to 10: **4**. Look at the NT questions before deciding.

Not tested in the core paper (not enough time): cells and enzymes, transport in plants, atomic structure and bonding, the periodic table, acids and salts, motion graphs, density and pressure, waves and light. The optional sciences cover them for the sciences the student chooses.

What to look for

- **Working scientifically** (question 6) is the best guide to IGCSE science readiness: a student who describes a pattern with both variables, names a control variable and suggests a real change of method (smaller steps, a graph) is ready for practical work in English. Compare with the working-scientifically questions in the optional sciences.
- **An English barrier** looks like: blank or wrong answers that become right when you read the question aloud. Science vocabulary in English (relative formula mass, specific heat capacity, extension, pivot, concentration, variable) is often the gap: note the words the student did not know in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- **Strong responses** use units (J, N, g), show the calculation in one line and give precise answers in question 6 (for example "test 6%, 7%, 8% and 9%").

6. Readiness for joining the second year of IGCSE

This section is guidance for the school to confirm, against its own admissions policy, the IGCSE syllabuses it offers (for example Cambridge IGCSE or Pearson Edexcel International GCSE), the entry requirements of its own sixth form, and the support it can provide. It is not a set of fixed rules. Record the results on the grading sheet (Section 7) first, then read the results together.

The question is different from Year 10. A Year 11 entrant joins courses that are already a year in, with the exams about 18 months away. For every subject, the first year's syllabus has to be caught up at the same time as the second year is taught, in English. So readiness means three things: English good enough to learn from lessons and texts **now**, not after a year's adjustment; subject knowledge close enough to the first-year syllabus that the catch-up is a list of topics, not a whole course; and the study habits and motivation to do the catching up. When these are not all in place, a **Year 10 start** is often the kinder and more successful route, and the family should hear this early rather than late.

English is the gateway. Every IGCSE subject except other languages is taught and examined in English. Look at the overall English band, and most closely at **reading and writing**. As a planning assumption, a student rarely moves up more than about one band a year in academic reading and writing, even with good support: a student at band C in Year 11 will probably sit the exams at C or D.

English band	What it usually means for joining Year 11	English course that may fit best
A New to English	Cannot yet follow subject lessons in English. Direct entry to the second year of IGCSE is not advisable (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).	A preparatory or foundation route, or a Year 10 start after intensive English, if the school has one.
B Early acquisition	Can follow simple, supported lessons, but IGCSE texts and exam questions will be very hard, and there is no time to adjust.	Usually a **Year 10 start** with an English as a Second Language course and a reduced subject load, if the school's policy allows; Year 11 only in exceptional cases (for example very strong maths and sciences, with an agreed plan).
C Developing competence	Can follow most lessons with support; subject vocabulary and extended writing will slow progress. Maths and the sciences are usually more accessible than essay-based subjects.	**English as a Second Language**; fewer essay-based subjects; consider a Year 10 start if the maths and science results are also band 2 or below.
D Competent	Usually ready to join IGCSE courses taught in English, with support for academic writing.	English as a Second Language at the higher level, or First Language English if reading is band E **and** writing is a strong D or E (see below). Check with the English department.
E Fluent	Ready for IGCSE study in English.	**First Language English** (and English Literature, if offered, where a year's set texts can be caught up).

What English band does a student realistically need? As a working guide for the school to test: **band D or above in reading and writing**, with listening and speaking at D or above, to join the second year of IGCSE with little extra support; **band C** with an English as a Second Language course, subject-language support and a limited subject load; **band B or below** usually means a Year 10 start. Review these thresholds once the first Year 11 entrants have sat their IGCSEs.

What the English results add. The listening can tell a competent student (D) from a fluent one (E); the reading paper has no text above age level, so it can show a competent reader but cannot on its own confirm a fluent one. Use the hardest parts as the evidence:

- **Listening Part B** is the best guide to following lessons taught by talk. Part B 6 or more: the student can follow a lesson-style explanation with subject vocabulary. Part B 0 to 2 with Part A secure: everyday listening is fine, but lessons will need visual support and key vocabulary in writing at first, and there is less time for this in Year 11.
- **Reading Part B** ("Homing") is the age-level text and the hardest reading on this paper. Part B 7 or 8, with writing at E or a strong D: close to the reading of a fluent speaker. Part B 6 or more otherwise: a competent reader of age-level texts, who will need support with the longest IGCSE texts. When First Language English is being considered,

confirm it with the English department (for example with a further reading task), because this paper has no text above age level.

English as a Second Language or First Language English? First Language English assumes the reading and writing of a fluent speaker and, in Year 11, a year's coursework or practice already done. It is usually the better fit only when reading is band E (Part B 7 or 8, with the sentence reading screen also pointing to E) and writing is band E or a strong D. For most students at band C or D, an English as a Second Language course is the better fit, and a good grade is more achievable. Check what the school's sixth form and likely universities ask for, because some ask for a particular course or grade; tell the family early.

Maths: Extended or Core tier, and what support. Read the total band with the three sub-scores (Section 4), allowing for NT. A Year 11 entrant from a Chinese school has usually been taught almost all of the maths on this paper, so NT explains fewer marks than in Year 10; the gaps are the IGCSE-only topics (fractional indices, functions, sequences, cumulative frequency, volume factors, bounds) and the calculator.

Maths result	What it suggests (for the school to confirm)
Band 4 (23 or more)	**Extended tier**, likely top set. Consider additional or further maths if the school offers it and the English allows.
Band 3 (17 to 22)	**Extended tier.** NT marks on the IGCSE-only topics are expected and are usually caught up in the first half term with a topic list.
Fluency 7 or more, word questions 3 or less (any band)	**Extended tier with support for the English of maths**: maths vocabulary, reading word problems, writing reasons in English. The gap is English, not maths: do not place in Core for this reason alone.
Fluency and word questions secure, applied 5 or less	**Extended tier**, with teaching in problem solving, graph reading and giving reasons ("show that", "explain"). Review after one term.
Band 2 (11 to 16), mostly NT and L	**Extended tier is still possible**: judge the band once taught, and review after six weeks.
Band 2 with errors on taught topics (questions 2, 3, 4, 6, 7 to 10, 13, 15)	**Core tier**, with a learning plan for the gaps; or a Year 10 start if the English is also band C or below. Move to Extended only if a review after one term shows the gaps have closed.
Band 1 not explained by NT or English	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9; the cognitive screen guide, Section 9). If an offer follows, maths support and the Core tier, and usually a Year 10 start. A band 1 that NT or L does explain is treated as band 2.

Science route: separate sciences, combined, or fewer subjects. Read the core science band with the optional sciences the student took (`Y11_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`: band 1 to 4 for each science, with its own NT notes) and with English.

Result	What it suggests (for the school to confirm)
Core science 3 or 4; each chosen science band 3 or 4; English D or E	**Separate sciences** (the sciences chosen), with a first-year topic list to catch up for each.
Core science 3 or 4; chosen sciences band 2 or 3 with NT explaining the gaps; English C or D	**Separate sciences for the strongest one or two**, or a **combined or co-ordinated science** course, with a catch-up plan; review after one term.
Chosen science band 2 with errors on taught topics	That science is not advisable in Year 11 unless the school can provide a full first-year catch-up; **fewer science subjects**, or a Year 10 start.
English B or C with any science result	**Fewer subjects** and a combined course where possible: the vocabulary load of three separate sciences in a second language, with a year to catch up, is the commonest cause of failure.
A science the student did not take	Not available to the student in Year 11 without a full first-year course; say so to the family, and ask about it in the interview if the choice is still open.

Subjects to catch up. For every subject the student will take, name on the grading sheet the first-year content to catch up (the NT topics in maths and the sciences; the set texts in English Literature; the first year of any humanities

course); the departments turn the list into a plan before the student starts. If the list for a subject is most of a year's syllabus, that subject should not be taken in Year 11.

The cognitive ability screen (`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide`) helps to plan support, never to select. Read its profile beside the paper results: non-verbal and quantitative both 9 or more with verbal low usually means strong reasoning with English as the gap (a good sign for catching up); processing speed well below the other parts suggests considering extra time and checking reading fluency; a strong profile with weak paper results points to gaps in prior learning or motivation rather than ability; all three parts 4 or less means discussing further assessment before a decision (the guide, Section 9). The screen is not standardised and is not a diagnosis.

When a Year 10 start would be wiser. Recommend a Year 10 start (or a preparatory route, if the school has one) when: English is band B or below; or English is band C and maths or science is band 2 or below on taught content; or the catch-up list for two or more subjects is most of a year's syllabus; or the interview shows that the student does not understand that they are joining a course a year in, or that the plan is the family's rather than the student's. Say to the family that a Year 10 start is a route to better IGCSE grades, not a judgement on the student. Students who join Year 11 from a school that already teaches IGCSE are the exception: for them, check which syllabus and which topics have been covered.

Reading the results together (examples of common profiles)

Profile	What it suggests	A possible plan (for the school to confirm)
English D or E; maths 3 or 4; core science 3 or 4; chosen sciences 3 or 4	Ready to join the second year.	Full subject load; English course by the table above; Extended maths; separate sciences; a short catch-up list per subject.
English E, with listening Part B high and reading Part B 7 or 8; writing E or a strong D	Listens like a fluent speaker and reads close to it.	First Language English (and Literature, if offered and the set texts can be caught up), if the English department agrees.
English C; maths fluency high, word questions well below it; sciences 3 or 4	Strong maths and science; English is the barrier.	Ready with support: English as a Second Language with subject-language support; Extended maths with vocabulary support; separate sciences for the strongest two, or combined; no more than one essay-based subject. Discuss a Year 10 start if the student also wants essay-based subjects.
English C; maths 2 or below on taught topics; sciences 2 or below	The gaps are too wide to close while learning the second year in a second language.	**Start in Year 10**, with English as a Second Language and a learning plan; or a preparatory route.
English B, any maths and science	The English gap is too wide for the second year of IGCSE.	Start in Year 10 with an English as a Second Language course and a reduced subject load, if the school's policy allows; otherwise a preparatory route or a later start.
English D or E; maths band 1 on taught topics	Not an English issue.	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9; the screen guide). If an offer follows, maths support, the Core tier and usually a Year 10 start.
Cognitive screen: non-verbal and quantitative high, verbal low; paper results band C in English	Strong reasoning; English is the gap.	A good candidate for catching up: ready with support, with English as a Second Language and a review after one term.
Strong results, but the interview shows the student does not understand that they are joining a course a year in, or the plan is the family's, not the student's	Readiness is not only academic.	Talk with the family and student about the catch-up load before an offer (Interview sheet, suitability strands). A serious mismatch, or any strand rated 1, goes to the head of section before any offer.

Use the Year 11 interview questions (subject choices and why, what the student knows about IGCSE, and joining a course a year in) to judge whether the student's plans are realistic and their own. Record the readiness judgement on

the grading sheet (the readiness for joining Year 11 boxes and the assessor's comment) and on the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

7. Recording the results

1. **Mark the student paper.** Every question has a mark box.
2. **Copy the totals onto the grading sheet** (`Y11_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). Record there too whether Part B of the listening was given, the maths sub-scores and profile (Section 4), the NT topics and L questions, the writing task chosen (A or B), any access arrangements and your comment.
3. **Mark the cognitive ability screen** from its guide and record the four raw scores (Non-verbal / 12, Quantitative / 12, Verbal / 12, Processing speed / 60) and a one-line profile note on the grading sheet. The screen has no band.
4. **Mark the optional sciences** from their mark scheme and record each science the student took (/ 15, band, NT, L) on the grading sheet; tick "not taken" for the others. If they were given on a second visit, record the date.
5. **Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`): the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes.
6. **Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet** before the interview.
7. **After the interview, put together** the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days. Write "Year 11, v3.1" beside the scores on it: the listening is out of 16, the reading paper is out of 16 (Parts A and B), the maths has three sub-scores, and the cognitive screen and the optional sciences have their own lines. The overall English band is the band most skills sit in: name any skill that is two or more bands lower.
8. **File the marked student paper, the screen booklet and the optional sciences booklet with them** (or shred them under the school's policy).

Year 11 only: readiness for joining the second year. Read the results together with Section 6, then tick on the grading sheet the English course (English as a Second Language, First Language or to decide), the maths tier (Extended, Core or to decide), the science route (separate sciences, combined, fewer subjects or to decide), the readiness (Ready, Ready with support, Start in Year 10 or Not yet) and the support needed, list the subjects and topics to catch up, and give your reasons in the assessor's comment.

Interviewer guide: Years 11 and 12

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each student go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y11_Y12`).

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme at post-16 (Year 11 joins the second year of IGCSE; Year 12 joins the first year of A Level). It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (3 to 5 minutes; start Level 9 for both Year 11 and Year 12; follow `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and write the points on the Reading front sheet, `forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Pace of speech. Speak at a steady, clear pace, with a short pause after each sentence. Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group, and use it for the instructions and meaning questions of the sentence reading too. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said": what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?
School and learning	Tell me about your school now. Which subject do you find hardest, and what do you do when work is difficult?	Do you like your school? Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard. What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?
Subject choices	Which IGCSE or A Level subjects would you like to take, and why? Who chose them: you, your parents, or both together?	Which subjects do you like best? Was it your idea?	How do they connect to what you want to study later?
	What do you know about the courses: the topics, the exams, any coursework?	Do you know what an IGCSE or an A Level is?	How is this course different from what you study now?
	What will you do if a subject is harder than you expected?	Would you ask a teacher for help?	How would you decide whether to keep going or to change subject?
Study and workload	How do you revise for a test? Tell me what you actually do.	Do you make notes? Do you practise questions?	Which methods work best for you, and how do you know?
	How many hours a week do you study outside lessons? Do you have tutoring?	Do you study at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?
	How do you manage deadlines when several subjects set work at the same time?	Do you use a planner or a list?	Tell me about a time you had too much to do. What did you do?
English for study	How do you feel about reading long texts in English, such as a textbook chapter or a novel?	Do you read in English? What do you read?	What do you do when a text has many words you do not know?

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
	Have you written an essay in English? Tell me about it.	Can you write a paragraph in English?	What is hardest about writing in English: the ideas, the organisation or the language?
	How do you feel about speaking in class, asking questions and giving your opinion in English?	Will you put your hand up in a lesson?	What would help you to speak more in lessons?
University plans	What would you like to do after school? Which countries or universities are you thinking about, and why?	Do you want to go to university? In China or another country?	Why does that place interest you? What might be difficult about studying there?
	What do you know about what those universities ask for: grades, subjects, English tests, interviews?	Do you know which grades you would need?	What have you found out yourself, and where did you look?
Interests and service	What do you enjoy outside school? Have you taken part in service, volunteering, competitions or a leadership role?	Do you like sport, music or art? Do you help at home or in your community?	What have you achieved that you are proud of, and what did you learn from it?
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school? How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	Do you have good friends? What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities, sleep and rest?
Boarding (only if the student will board)	Have you lived away from home before? How do you manage your own routines: sleep, getting up on time, washing clothes?	Have you stayed away from home for a week or more? Do you get yourself up in the morning?	What will be hardest about boarding, and how would you deal with feeling homesick?
Values	A friend asks you to send them your essay so they can hand it in as their own. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy work?	Why does honesty matter in learning?
Year 11 only	You would join the second year of a two-year IGCSE course. What does that mean for you, and how would you catch up?	Do you know that the other students started the course a year ago? Would you ask for extra lessons?	In which subjects do you expect the biggest gap, and how would you close it?
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school or the courses?	Do you have any questions?	

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, using the evidence from the whole interview, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** (how much of your English they understood) with the same letters. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

3. Suitability

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet from what you saw and heard: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits
Independent study and readiness for post-16 work	Can describe how they study on their own, realistic about the workload, has read about the courses

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rate it on the Interview sheet in the same way.

4. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)
- Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary
- Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, they note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 12. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	9	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25	25	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Use a short pause after each sentence, and a longer one with the younger students. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 12 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 12
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.

Year 11 Admission Assessment v3.1: optional sciences, mark scheme

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_v3.1` (the student paper: Biology, Chemistry and Physics, 15 marks and 15 minutes each). The core science paper (10 marks, everyone) is in the main student paper and its assessor instructions; this document covers only the optional sciences.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y11_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`): each science out of 15, the band, NT and L, and a "not taken" tick for any science not sat.

Who this is for. Students applying for **Year 11** (age 15 on 1 September), who join the **second year of a two-year IGCSE course**. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 9 (初三)**: biology in Grades 7 and 8, physics in Grades 8 and 9 (including electricity and magnetism), and chemistry in Grade 9 only (atoms, the periodic table, acids and bases, simple equations and mass calculations by proportion; **the mole is not taught** before 高一). A student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 10 (高一). Ask which grade and textbooks the student has used.

What it measures. Each paper tests the **first year of IGCSE** in that science (biology: cells, enzymes, nutrition, transport in plants and humans, respiration and gas exchange; chemistry: particles, atomic structure, bonding, formulae and equations, the mole and reacting masses, acids, bases and salts, the periodic table; physics: motion and forces, energy, density and pressure, thermal physics, waves and light), with at least one calculation, one data question, one two-mark "explain" question and one working-scientifically question in each. The question is whether the student can **join the second year of that separate science, taught in English**, with a year's syllabus to catch up. Section 5 says how the result feeds that judgement.

1. How to give the optional sciences

Which sciences	Only the sciences the student will take in Year 11, as agreed with the family before the day (from the application form or the first conversation). The assessor ticks them in the box on the cover: **Biology, Chemistry, Physics**. If the choice is still open, give the sciences under consideration (all three take about 50 minutes with a break). Tick "not taken" on the grading sheet for any science not sat. Never give a science as a surprise.
When	After the cognitive ability screen, in the order Biology, Chemistry, Physics (leave out any not taken), with a **short break after two sciences**. If the day is too long, the optional sciences (and the interview) may be on a **second visit**: tell the family in advance.
Time	**15 minutes each**, timed strictly, with a two-minute warning. Do not run two sciences together as one 30-minute block: the time limit is part of the measure.
Materials	The student paper, a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. Keep a **scientific calculator** on your desk: give it for **Chemistry question 7** and for the **whole Physics section**, and take it back after. In a group, give each student theirs when they reach that point.
Marking	Mark in the boxes on the paper. B1 is a mark for a correct answer or point; M1 is a method mark (given for correct working even if the final answer is wrong); A1 is an accuracy mark for the final answer (usually needs the M1). Write **NT** beside any question the student says they have not been taught and **L** beside any question said once in Chinese.

Say (before the first science): "You will do [Biology, Chemistry and Physics / the sciences ticked on your cover]. Each one has 15 marks and takes 15 minutes. I can read any question to you in English, as many times as you like. Write all your answers in English. If you have not learnt a topic, tell me and go on to the next question. You can use a calculator only where the paper says so, and I will give it to you then. Do you have any questions?"

Say (at the start of each science): "Turn to the [Biology / Chemistry / Physics] page. You have 15 minutes. Look at every question: later questions may be on topics you know. Start now." Then at 13 minutes: "Two more minutes." At 15 minutes: "Stop now, please. Thank you."

Access rules (the pack's rules for maths and science)

	Rule
Reading aloud	Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as the student asks. You may point to the diagram, table or graph. Do not explain the science or define a word (for example "denatured" or "anomalous"): reading the question is all.
Chinese	Not used by the assessor. If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Record the number of L questions on the grading sheet: it is evidence about English.
Answers	**All answers in English.** Numbers, symbols, formulae, ticks, circles, drawings and working all count. An explanation written in Chinese scores 0, including the two-mark "Explain" answers.
Calculator	Only where the paper says: **Chemistry question 7** and the **whole Physics section**. Biology: no calculator (the arithmetic is simple).
Not yet taught	If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics on the grading sheet; Section 5 says how to allow for them. The tables below say which questions are likely NT for a student from a Chinese school.
Stopping	The student may stop a science when they have done what they can. Encourage them to look at every question first. If a student is distressed, stop, take a break and record it.

Extra time, a reader or other arrangements for a known need are allowed: record them on the grading sheet.

2. Biology (15 minutes, 15 marks)

What a Year 11 entrant may not have been taught. Chinese middle-school biology (Grades 7 and 8) covers cells, plants, transport, digestion, breathing and the circulation well, so most of this paper is familiar. The **vocabulary of IGCSE biology in English** (chloroplast, magnification, xylem, transpiration, ventricle, denatured, active site, anomalous) is the main barrier: read questions aloud when asked. Likely NT: question 2(b) (Benedict's test), question 6(b) (denaturing and the active site, a 高一 idea).

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Plant cell structure	(a) D (b) B	B1 each. The letter alone is enough; accept the letter with the correct name. (a) C (the nucleus) scores 0: the nucleus controls the cell but has no chlorophyll. (b) A (the cell wall) scores 0: the wall supports, the membrane controls what enters and leaves.	Secure (Grade 7 biology: 细胞壁, 细胞膜, 叶绿体).
2	Food tests: reading a table	(a) A (b) Food B contains (reducing) sugar	(a) B1: A only (starch with iodine and protein with biuret). (b) B1: reducing sugar, sugar or glucose. Do not accept "starch" or "protein".	The iodine test for starch is Grade 7. Benedict's and biuret tests are not usually taught before IGCSE, so (b) may be NT; (a) can be answered from the table if the student knows what iodine and biuret show.
3	Magnification (calculation)	600	M1 for 30 ÷ 0.05 seen or used; A1 for 600 (accept ×600). 0.0017 (0.05 ÷ 30) scores 0. A slip in the division (for example 60) scores M1 only. No calculator.	Chinese microscope work gives "magnification = eyepiece × objective"; the drawing-to-real calculation is IGCSE-specific, but the formula is printed, so the arithmetic (dividing by 0.05) is the test.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
4	Transport in plants	(a) X (xylem) (b) transpiration	B1 each. (b) accept "transpiration" or a correct description ("water evaporates from the leaves"). Do not accept "respiration" or "photosynthesis".	Secure (Grade 7 biology: 导管 xylem, 筛管 phloem, 蒸腾作用 transpiration). The English word may be new: a correct description scores.
5	The heart	(a) D (b) B	B1 each. (a) C (left atrium) scores 0. (b) D (left ventricle, which pumps to the body) is the common confusion and scores 0. A student who answers A or C has reversed atria and ventricles: note it.	Secure (Grade 7 biology: four chambers, the two circulations). "Ventricle" (心室) in English may need the read-aloud; the diagram carries the question.
6	Enzymes: data and explain	(a) 40 (b) The enzyme is denatured; the active site changes shape so the substrate no longer fits	(a) B1: accept 39 to 41. (b) 2 marks: B1 "denatured" (accept "destroyed by the heat", "its shape has changed"); B1 the active site changes shape, or the substrate no longer fits or binds. "The enzyme dies" scores 0 for the first point (enzymes are not alive), but a correct second point still scores. "It is too hot" alone scores 0: it repeats the question.	Grade 7 biology meets digestive enzymes and that temperature affects them; "denatured" and "active site" are 高一 biology. (a) is secure; (b) may be NT, and a student who writes "the enzyme is destroyed by heat" without the active site shows the idea and scores 1.
7	Working scientifically: anomaly and mean (data)	(a) 45 circled (b) 30	(a) B1. (b) B1 for 30 ((29 + 31) ÷ 2). 35 (the mean of all three) scores 0 for (b) but (a) still scores if 45 is circled.	Means and odd results are familiar from maths; "anomalous" is explained in the question. Secure.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 4: **1**; 5 to 7: **2**; 8 to 11: **3**; 12 to 15: **4**. Look at the NT questions before deciding (Section 5).

Not tested (not enough time): osmosis and diffusion, the digestive system in detail, the lungs and alveoli, the word equation for respiration. Ask about them in the interview if they matter.

What to look for

- **Explaining** (question 6b) separates a student who has learnt biology as explanation from one who has learnt it as facts: "denatured, active site changes shape, substrate cannot fit" in any words is IGCSE-ready thinking, even in simple English.
- **An English barrier** looks like: blank or wrong answers that become right when the question is read aloud, or correct biology in the wrong words (for example "the water goes out of the leaf as gas" for transpiration). Note the words the student did not know in the assessor's comment.
- **Strong responses** give units and precise values (40 °C, 30 breaths per minute, ×600) and handle the data questions (2, 6a, 7) quickly, leaving time for the explanation.

3. Chemistry (15 minutes, 15 marks)

What a Year 11 entrant may not have been taught. Chinese chemistry starts in **Grade 9 only**, so a Year 11 entrant has had one year: the particle model, atomic structure with electron-shell diagrams (原子结构示意图), the layout of the periodic table, acids, bases, pH and neutralisation, chemical equations, conservation of mass and **mass calculations by proportion** (化学方程式的计算). **The mole is not taught** before 高一, and nor are dot-and-cross diagrams, "covalent" as a term, or the group trends of the periodic table. Likely NT: questions 3(b), 4(a) and the mole method in 7(b), although 7(b) can be done by proportion. A student who comes mid-way through 高一 may know the mole.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Particles: states of matter	C	B1.	Secure (Grade 9 chemistry and Grade 8 physics: 分子, the particle model).
2	Atomic structure	(a) 19 (b) 7	(a) B1 for 19 (9 + 10). 9 (protons only) or 28 (all particles) scores 0. (b) B1: accept 7, VII, 17 (the IUPAC group number) or "the halogens".	Electron-shell diagrams with 2, 7 are Grade 9, so the diagram is familiar. "Mass number" (质量数) is 高一; Grade 9 uses relative atomic mass, so a student may answer 19 from that. The group from the outer electrons is touched on in Grade 9.
3	The periodic table	(a) Z (b) W	B1 each. (b) accept W only: X (Group 2) reacts slowly with water; Y and Z are non-metals.	The layout is Grade 9 (元素周期表), but the groups' names and reactivity trends are 高一: (b) may be NT. (a) is a fair test of whether the student knows where the noble gases sit.
4	Covalent bonding	(a) covalent (b) 4	(a) B1: covalent, covalent bonds, or "sharing (pairs of) electrons". "Ionic" scores 0. (b) B1: 4.	Dot-and-cross diagrams and the word "covalent" (共价键) are 高一: (a) may be NT. The diagram lets any student count the shared pairs for (b).
5	Acids, bases and salts	(a) D (b) sodium chloride	(a) B1. (b) B1: sodium chloride or NaCl. "Salt" alone scores 0 (too general).	Secure (Grade 9: pH, 中和反应, salts). Naming compounds in English is the likely barrier: accept the formula.
6	Working scientifically: variables	(a) The metal (which metal is used) (b) One control variable	(a) B1: the metal, the type of metal. "The number of bubbles" scores 0 (that is what she measures). (b) B1: the volume of acid; the concentration of acid; the temperature; the size, mass or surface area of the metal piece; the time (one minute); the type of acid. Do not accept "the metal" or "the bubbles".	Secure: 控制变量法 (controlling variables) is taught from Grade 8 physics, so the idea is familiar even if "variable" needs the read-aloud.
7	Reacting masses: explain and calculate (calculator allowed)	(a) Magnesium reacts with (combines with) oxygen from the air; the oxygen adds mass, so the product is heavier than the magnesium (b) 20 g	(a) 2 marks: B1 for magnesium reacting or combining with oxygen (from the air); B1 for the oxygen adding mass (the product contains oxygen atoms as well as magnesium; mass of product = mass of magnesium + mass of oxygen used). "It gets heavier because it burns" scores 0. (b) 2 marks: M1 for moles of Mg = 12 ÷ 24 = 0.5, or Mr(MgO) = 40 used with 0.5 mol, or the mass ratio 48 : 80 (or 24 : 40) set up; A1 for 20 g. The **proportion method** taught in China (24 g of Mg makes 40 g of MgO, so 12 g makes 20 g) earns full marks. 8 g (the mass of oxygen only) scores M1.	Conservation of mass (质量守恒定律) and mass calculations from equations are Grade 9, so most students can do both parts **without moles**. The mole itself is 高一: mark NT only if the student says the calculation is new to them.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 4: **1**; 5 to 7: **2**; 8 to 11: **3**; 12 to 15: **4**. Allow for NT (Section 5): a student from a Chinese school may NT 3(b), 4(a) and part of 7 and still be ready.

Not tested (not enough time): ionic bonding and formulae of ions, separating mixtures, metals and reactivity in detail, percentage composition. Ask about them in the interview if they matter.

What to look for

- **Question 7** is the best guide: a student who explains the mass gain through oxygen combining, and calculates 20 g by any correct route, is ready for quantitative chemistry in IGCSE even with the mole still to learn.
- **An English barrier** looks like: chemistry correct in symbols (NaCl, the shells, 2 : 1 ratios) but the words missing or wrong (sodium chloride, covalent, alkaline). Record the words the student did not know.
- **Weak chemistry** (as opposed to NT) looks like: wrong answers on Grade 9 content that was taught: question 1, 2(a), 5 and 7(b) by proportion.

4. Physics (15 minutes, 15 marks)

What a Year 11 entrant may not have been taught. Chinese physics runs through Grades 8 and 9: speed, density, forces, pressure, simple machines, work and power, heat transfer, sound, light (reflection and refraction) and, in Grade 9, electricity and magnetism. **Acceleration and speed-time graphs, wavelength, frequency and wave speed, and the formula for gravitational potential energy are 高一** topics, so questions 3(b), 5 and 6(a) may be NT, although every formula needed is printed in the box at the start of the section. A student joining mid-way through 高一 usually knows motion graphs and acceleration.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Resultant force	20 N to the right	B1 for both the size and the direction (20 N alone, or "right" alone, scores 0). 40 N scores 0.	Secure (Grade 8 physics: 同一直线上二力的合成).
2	Density (calculation)	2.7 g/cm^3	M1 for the volume 10 × 5 × 2 = 100 cm^3 (seen or used); A1 for 2.7. Accept 2700 kg/m^3. 27 (270 ÷ 10) scores 0.	Secure (Grade 8 physics: 密度 = 质量 ÷ 体积). Fast and accurate work here is expected.
3	Speed-time graph: describe and acceleration	(a) Constant (steady) speed of 12 m/s (b) 3 m/s^2	(a) B1: constant speed, steady speed, not accelerating; accept "stays at 12 m/s". "Stopped" or "not moving" scores 0: this is the distance-time confusion. (b) M1 for 12 ÷ 4 (change in speed ÷ time); A1 for 3. 48 (12 × 4) scores 0; 24 (the distance travelled in the first 4 s, from the area) scores 0.	Speed-time graphs and acceleration (加速度) are 高一: both parts may be NT. The formula is printed, so a student who reads the graph correctly can still score; a student who answers "stopped" in (a) has read it as a distance-time graph.
4	Thermal physics: cooling curves (data)	(a) 50 (b) black	(a) B1: accept 49 to 51. (b) B1.	Reading the graph is secure. Black surfaces as better emitters and absorbers of radiation appear in some Grade 9 textbooks (热传递), otherwise IGCSE: (b) may be NT, but many students know it from everyday experience.
5	Waves: wavelength and wave speed (calculation)	(a) 2 (b) 10	(a) B1: 2 m. 4 (the whole length) or 1 (half a wave) scores 0. (b) B1 for 10 (5 × 2); allow follow-through from the student's (a) (for example 5 × 4 = 20 if (a) was 4).	Wavelength, frequency and wave speed = frequency × wavelength are 高一: likely NT. Sound as a vibration is Grade 8, without the equation. The formula is printed; the test is whether the student can read a wavelength off a diagram.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
6	Energy: GPE and the explain question	(a) 800 J (b) Friction (or air resistance) acts on the skateboard; energy is transferred to the thermal store (heats the wheels, ramp and air) and sound, so less is left as kinetic energy	(a) B1 for 800 (40 × 10 × 2). 80 (g forgotten) scores 0. (b) 2 marks: B1 for friction between the wheels and the ramp, or air resistance; B1 for energy transferred to the thermal store, heating, or sound (accept "wasted as heat", "dissipated"). "Energy is lost" alone scores 0: it must say where the energy goes.	Grade 9 physics covers gravitational potential energy and friction qualitatively; the formula mass × g × height is 高一 but is printed. (a) may be NT; (b) is within reach of any student who has met friction and heating.
7	Working scientifically: light, concluding and accuracy	(a) The angle of reflection equals the angle of incidence (b) One improvement	(a) B1: "r = i", "the angles are equal", "the angle of reflection is the same as the angle of incidence". "They both increase" scores 0 (a description, not the conclusion). (b) B1: repeat each angle and take a mean; use a narrower ray (a thinner slit); mark the ray with two points far apart before drawing it; use a sharp pencil or a larger protractor; make sure the mirror stands exactly on the drawn line; measure from the normal carefully. "Be more careful" or "use a better protractor" alone scores 0.	Secure: the law of reflection (光的反射定律) is Grade 8 physics, and investigations with a discussion of error are familiar from 探究 lessons.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 4: **1**; 5 to 7: **2**; 8 to 11: **3**; 12 to 15: **4**. Allow for NT (Section 5): a student from a Chinese school may NT 3, 5 and 6(a) and still be ready.

Not tested (not enough time): pressure in liquids, work and power, specific heat capacity, refraction and lenses, the electromagnetic spectrum. Electricity and magnetism are second-year IGCSE topics and are not tested; a Chinese student will usually have done them in Grade 9.

What to look for

- **Using a printed formula on a new topic** (questions 3b, 5b, 6a) is the best guide to physics readiness: a student who has never met acceleration but reads the graph, chooses the right formula and gets 3 m/s^2 will manage the second year of IGCSE with the first-year topics taught quickly.
- **An English barrier** looks like: calculations right, descriptions and explanations blank or in the wrong words (for example "the speed is same" for constant speed). "Emitter", "constant", "resultant" and "anomalous" are the words most often unknown: record them.
- **Strong responses** show working, give units (g/cm^3, m/s^2, J) and in question 6(b) say where the energy goes, not just that it is "lost".

5. Band guide and the readiness judgement for separate sciences

Band guide for each science (provisional, review after the first 20 to 30 candidates):

Marks out of 15	Band	What it usually means
0 to 4	**1** Well below expected	Not ready to join this science a year in unless NT or English explains most of the gap.
5 to 7	**2** Working towards	Some of the first year secure; a catch-up plan for the rest is needed.
8 to 11	**3** Expected	Ready to join the second year of this science with the NT topics taught early in the term.
12 to 15	**4** Greater depth	Secure first-year content; likely to do well in the separate science.

Allow for NT and L before you read the band. The likely NT questions for a student from a Chinese school are: biology 2(b) and 6(b); chemistry 3(b), 4(a) and 7 (the mole method only); physics 3, 5 and 6(a). Add up the marks available on the questions that were **not** NT and judge the band on those (for example 9 out of 11 on the non-NT questions in physics is band 3 or 4, not band 2). Then list the NT topics in the assessor's comment: they are the catch-up plan. Treat a band 1 that NT or L explains as band 2 (as in the guide, Section 9).

How the result feeds the readiness judgement. A Year 11 entrant joins courses that are already a year in. For each separate science the student wants to take, the question is whether they can **catch up the first-year syllabus while following the second year in English**. Read the science band with the English band (reading and writing above all, because IGCSE science papers are long and the command words matter) and with the core science question on working scientifically. **This is guidance for the school to confirm** against its own syllabuses, timetable and support; it is not a set of fixed rules.

Result in a science	What it suggests	A possible plan (for the school to confirm)
Band 4, or band 3 with the gaps all NT; English D or E	Ready to join the second year of this separate science.	Separate science; the NT topics taught in the first weeks (or by a short bridging course before the term starts).
Band 3 or 4; English C	The science is secure; the English of science is the risk.	Separate science with support for subject language (key vocabulary, command words, writing explanations), and not too many essay-based subjects. Review after one term.
Band 2 with NT explaining most of the gap	Likely to manage with a structured catch-up.	Separate science with a written catch-up plan for the first-year topics (the NT list) and a review at half term; consider a bridging course.
Band 2 with errors on taught topics (the "Secure" rows above)	The first year of this science is not secure, and the second year builds on it.	Combined or co-ordinated science (if the school offers it), or fewer separate sciences, or a **Year 10 start** if the student's age allows; discuss with the family.
Band 1 not explained by NT or English	Joining this science a year in is not advisable.	Not this separate science in Year 11; a Year 10 start or a different subject mix. If the band 1 is across all three sciences with English D or E, further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).
Strong in two sciences, band 1 or 2 in the third	Usual profile: strength and interest are uneven.	Offer the two strong sciences; take the third only with a catch-up plan and the student's own commitment (check in the interview).
Good bands, but English B	The science can be followed with pictures and formulae; the exam papers cannot yet be read or written.	Only with an ESL course, a reduced subject load and close review, if the school's policy allows; otherwise discuss a preparatory route or a Year 10 start.

Record the readiness judgement for the science route (separate sciences, combined, or fewer subjects) on the grading sheet's readiness box and in the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`), with the NT topics named as the catch-up plan.

6. Recording the results

1. **Mark each science on the paper.** Every question has a mark box; write NT and L in the margin where they apply.
2. **Copy each total onto the grading sheet** (`Y11_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`): Biology / 15, Chemistry / 15, Physics / 15, each with its band (1 to 4), the NT topics, the number of L questions, and a tick in "not taken" for any science not sat.
3. **Write the assessor's comment**: the NT topics for each science (the catch-up plan), the English words that were a barrier, what the working-scientifically and explain questions showed, and whether the calculator was used.
4. **Judge readiness** for the science route with Section 5, together with the English bands and the core science result, and tick it on the grading sheet's readiness box.
5. **Complete the final mark sheet** (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) with the other results within two working days, and **file the marked paper** with the student's papers (or shred it under the school's policy).

Cognitive Ability Screen: guide for assessors

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Y11_Y12` (the student booklet, 14 pages). The screen is the same for Year 11 and Year 12 entrants. The grading sheet for the year applied for records the result.

What this screen is for, and what it is not. The screen gives the school a quick picture of how a student reasons with shapes, numbers and words, and how fast they work on a simple task. Its only purpose is to **plan learning support** once a student joins: which students may need help with English rather than with thinking, who may need extra time, where to look more closely. It is **never used to select**: no offer is made or refused on the strength of it, and it does not appear in the decision box of the final mark sheet. It is **not standardised**: the items were written by the school, there are no national norms, and the result is a set of **raw scores and the shape of the profile**, nothing more. It is **not a diagnosis** of any learning difficulty; that needs a specialist assessment. Until the school has its own reference, read every result cautiously. The school should **build its own reference once about 30 students have taken the screen** (Section 6.4).

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record the four raw scores and the profile note on the student's grading sheet.

1. At a glance

The screen comes after the second break, before the optional sciences. It can be taken in a small group with one invigilator. Timing is **strict**: every student gets exactly the same time, or the scores cannot be compared.

Part	What it measures	Time	Items and answers	What to watch
1	Non-verbal reasoning	**8 minutes**	12 items: pattern matrices, figure series, odd one out. Answer: a letter A to E.	No English needed beyond the instruction. The best guide to reasoning for a student with little English.
2	Quantitative reasoning	**8 minutes**	12 items: number series, number analogies, number matrices, simple relationships. Answer: a number, or a letter for item 6. No calculator.	Only simple arithmetic: it tests spotting the rule, not maths knowledge.
3	Verbal reasoning	**6 minutes**	12 items: word analogies, odd one out, simple deductions. Answer: a letter A to E.	English-dependent. Common words only, but a low score usually reflects English, not reasoning.
4	Processing speed	Practice untimed, then **90 seconds**	Symbol-digit coding: a key of 9 symbols, a practice row of 6, then 60 boxes. Score: correct boxes in 90 seconds, maximum 60.	Stop everyone at exactly 90 seconds. Check the practice row before the timed task.
	Total	**about 25 minutes** with instructions	Student booklet (14 pages); pencil and rubber; a timer that shows seconds	Record on the grading sheet: Non-verbal / 12, Quantitative / 12, Verbal / 12, Processing speed / 60, profile note.

You need: one student booklet per student, a pencil and rubber each, a stopwatch or a timer that shows seconds (a phone timer is fine), this guide, and the student's grading sheet. No calculators, no rulers needed, no dictionaries.

2. Before you start

Room. Quiet, bright, a clock the students can see, the booklet face down. The student writes their name on the cover. Students sitting the screen in a group should not be able to see each other's booklets.

Say (welcome): "This next part is a little different. It is a cognitive ability screen. It is not a test you can pass or fail, and it is not used to decide whether you get a place. It helps us plan how to support you when you join us. There are

four short parts, and each part is timed. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets them all right. If you are not sure, choose the answer you think is best and go on. I will tell you when to start and when to stop each part. You may not use a calculator. Please do not turn any page until I say so. Open the booklet and read the first page with me." Read the Welcome and How to answer sections aloud, then the table of parts.

Access rules for the screen

Rule	What it means
Instructions	You may read the instructions and the worked examples of any part aloud in English, and repeat them as often as a student asks. You may read any item in Parts 1, 2 and 4 aloud. In **Part 3** read only the instructions and the examples, not the items: the words are the task.
Chinese	**Not used** by staff for any part of the screen, even where a Chinese-speaking colleague is present: the screen is not scored in the decision and nothing is lost by a student not understanding a word in Part 3, whereas a translation would make the verbal score unreadable. Do not mark L on this screen.
Calculator	**No calculator** in any part. The arithmetic in Part 2 is small on purpose.
Time	**No extra time** within the screen, even for a student with a known need for extra time in the papers: the time limits are part of what the screen measures. Instead, **note any known need** (extra time, a reader, dyslexia, ADHD, a visual or hearing difficulty, or anything the family has told you) on the grading sheet beside the profile note, so that the profile is read in that light.
Answers	Letters and numbers only, so English is a barrier in Part 3 alone. A crossed-out answer with a new one beside it is marked on the new one. Two answers left standing score 0.
Stopping	A student may put their pencil down early in any part and sit quietly; do not let them turn the page. Never push a distressed student: stop, take a break, and record it.

Do not explain an item, give hints, say whether an answer is right, or tell a student to hurry (except in the Part 4 script, which asks everyone to work fast). Say "thank you" rather than "good" or "right".

3. Giving the screen: the script and the timing

Keep the timer where you can see it. Start the timer the moment you say "Start" and say "Stop" when it reaches the limit, in the middle of a sentence if need be. Collect no booklets between parts: the student simply waits at the stop banner.

Part 1, Non-verbal reasoning (8 minutes). Say: "Turn to Part 1, Non-verbal reasoning, on page 2. Look at the example with me." Read the example aloud and point to the rule across the rows. **Say:** "There are three kinds of question." Read the three lines. **Say:** "You have 8 minutes for 12 questions. Write the letter in the box. If you are not sure, choose the best answer and go on. Stop when you reach the banner. Start." Time 8 minutes. Give a one-minute warning: "One minute left." At 8 minutes **say:** "Stop. Pencils down. Please wait."

Part 2, Quantitative reasoning (8 minutes). Say: "Turn to Part 2, Quantitative reasoning, on page 7. No calculator. Look at the three examples with me." Read the three examples aloud. **Say:** "In most questions you write a number. In question 6 you write a letter. You have 8 minutes for 12 questions. Start." Time 8 minutes, with a one-minute warning. At 8 minutes **say:** "Stop. Pencils down. Please wait."

Part 3, Verbal reasoning (6 minutes). Say: "Turn to Part 3, Verbal reasoning, on page 10. This part is about words. Look at the three examples with me." Read the three examples aloud. **Say:** "Write the letter in the box. If you do not know a word, choose the best answer and go on. I cannot explain any words in this part. You have 6 minutes for 12 questions. Start." Time 6 minutes, with a one-minute warning. At 6 minutes **say:** "Stop. Pencils down. Please wait."

Part 4, Processing speed (practice, then 90 seconds). Say: "Turn to Part 4, Processing speed, on page 13. Look at the key. Every symbol has a number: the circle is 1, the triangle is 2, the square is 3, the plus is 4, the cross is 5, the diamond is 6, the line is 7, the V is 8 and the T is 9. Under each symbol you write its number. Look at the example: a circle, so 1; a plus, so 4. Now do the practice row. Take your time. Use the key." Wait until every student has filled the six boxes (about 30 seconds). Check each practice row against the answers in Section 4.4; if a box is wrong, point to the symbol and the key and let the student correct it. Make sure every student has understood before the timed task. **Say:** "Now the timed task. Turn to page 14. The key is at the top of the page. When I say start, write the number for

each symbol. Go from left to right along each row, then start the next row. Do not skip any boxes. Work as fast as you can, but try not to make mistakes. You have 90 seconds. When I say stop, put your pencil down at once. Ready? Start." Time **exactly 90 seconds**; no warning. **Say:** "Stop. Pencils down." Do not let anyone finish the box they are on. **Say:** "Thank you. That is the end of the screen."

Timing in a group. Everyone starts and stops each part together. A student who arrives late sits the screen on another occasion: do not start them part-way through.

4. Answers

4.1 Part 1: Non-verbal reasoning

Mark the letter only. Each item has one correct answer; the rule is given so that you can check a disputed answer and so that a future author can see what each item tests.

Item	Type	Answer	The rule
1	Series	**C**	The number of dots goes up by one each time (1, 2, 3, 4), so the next figure has 5 dots.
2	Matrix	**B**	Each row has one shape; across the row there are 1, 2 then 3 of it. Row 3 needs three triangles.
3	Odd one out	**D**	In four figures the black dot is inside the shape. In D it is outside.
4	Series	**B**	The arrow turns 45 degrees clockwise each step (up, up-right, right, down-right), so the next points down.
5	Matrix	**A**	Each row and each column holds a circle, a square and a triangle once, and white, grey and black once. Row 3 lacks a square and white: a white square.
6	Odd one out	**E**	The number of dots equals the number of sides (triangle 3, square 4, pentagon 5, hexagon 6). E is a pentagon with 4 dots.
7	Series	**C**	Two things change: the black quarter moves one place clockwise each step (so it returns to the top left), and the lines below go up by one (1, 2, 3, 4, so 5). Only C has both.
8	Matrix	**D**	The third cell in each row holds all the lines of the first two cells added together (row 1: vertical plus horizontal; row 2: the two diagonals). Row 3: vertical and one diagonal, plus horizontal and the other diagonal, gives all four lines.
9	Odd one out	**A**	B, C, D and E are the same flag figure turned by 0, 90, 180 and 270 degrees. A is its mirror image: with the ball at the bottom, the flag points left instead of right.
10	Series	**E**	The shaded sectors go up by one each step (1, 2, 3, 4, so 5) and the small black square alternates top-left, bottom-right, so it is top-left next. Only E has 5 sectors and the square top-left.
11	Matrix	**B**	The third cell shows the small squares that are black in exactly one of the first two cells, not in both (row 1: top-left and top-right, with top-right, leaves top-left; row 2: top-left and bottom-left, with bottom-left and bottom-right, leaves top-left and bottom-right). Row 3: bottom-left is black in both, so the answer is top-left, top-right and bottom-right. A simple "add them" rule fails row 1, and "take away" fails row 2.
12	Matrix	**D**	Three rules at once. The outer shape and the inner shape each appear once in every row and column (a Latin square), and the inner shading goes white, grey, black across each row. Row 3 lacks a square outside and a triangle inside, and the third column is black: a square with a black triangle.

4.2 Part 2: Quantitative reasoning

Accept the number written in any clear form (for example 20 or 20.0). Working in the margin is fine and is not marked.

Item	Type	Answer	The rule
1	Series	**20**	Add 4 each time.
2	Series	**30**	Take away 5 each time.
3	Analogy	**5**	The second number is half the first (6 to 3, 8 to 4).

Item	Type	Answer	The rule
4	Matrix	**9**	In each row the first two numbers add to make the third (3 + 4 = 7, 6 + 2 = 8, 5 + 4 = 9).
5	Series	**32**	Double each time.
6	Relationship	**E**	2/3 is about 0.67, larger than 0.6, 3/5 (also 0.6), 0.55 and 1/2.
7	Series	**17**	The gaps grow by one: +1, +2, +3, +4, so +5.
8	Analogy	**13**	Double the first number and take away 1 (4 to 7, 10 to 19); 2 × 7 is 14, take away 1 gives 13.
9	Matrix	**21**	In each row the first two numbers multiply to make the third (2 × 3 = 6, 4 × 5 = 20, 3 × 7 = 21).
10	Relationship	**4**	Two circles and a triangle make 14, and one circle and a triangle make 9, so a circle is 5 and the triangle is 4.
11	Series	**38**	Two steps repeat: add 1, then double (3, 4, 8, 9, 18, 19), so the next is 19 × 2 = 38.
12	Analogy	**50**	Square the first number and add 1 (3 to 10, 5 to 26); 7 × 7 + 1 = 50.

In items 3, 8 and 12 two pairs are given so that only one rule fits both.

4.3 Part 3: Verbal reasoning

Item	Type	Answer	The reason
1	Analogy	**B**	Hot and cold are opposites; the opposite of big is small.
2	Odd one out	**C**	Four are fruits; a chair is not.
3	Analogy	**A**	A bird flies; a fish swims (what the animal does, not where it lives).
4	Deduction	**C**	Li Na is older than Tom, who is older than Mei, so Mei is the youngest.
5	Odd one out	**D**	Four are feelings; tall is not.
6	Analogy	**E**	A shoe is worn on the foot; a hat is worn on the head.
7	Deduction	**A**	All of Class 4 play football and Wang Hao is in Class 4, so he plays football. The other sentences may be true but do not have to be.
8	Odd one out	**D**	Four are lengths of time; a clock is an object.
9	Analogy	**B**	Begin and end are a pair of opposites in a process; ask and answer are the same kind of pair.
10	Deduction	**B**	Sofia is on Amir's left and Jun on his right, so Amir is in the middle.
11	Analogy	**A**	Always and never are opposites; the opposite of everything is nothing.
12	Deduction	**E**	If rain always stops the game and the game did not stop, it did not rain. A (it rained) is the common error: it reverses the rule.

The vocabulary is kept within the most common two thousand or so English words. Even so, a student new to English may not know "afraid", "angry", "begin" or "middle": that is the English barrier the profile is designed to show, not a fault in the student's reasoning.

4.4 Part 4: Processing speed

Practice row (not scored): square 3, circle 1, diamond 6, T 9, triangle 2, line 7.

The sixty boxes, row by row from the left:

Row 1	**2**	**9**	**8**	**9**	**3**	**8**	**7**	**5**	**6**	**4**	**5**	**9**
Row 2	**8**	**6**	**4**	**1**	**2**	**8**	**5**	**7**	**4**	**7**	**4**	**9**
Row 3	**8**	**6**	**3**	**1**	**6**	**1**	**7**	**3**	**7**	**2**	**7**	**5**
Row 4	**6**	**3**	**5**	**4**	**9**	**2**	**1**	**3**	**6**	**5**	**2**	**7**
Row 5	**4**	**9**	**1**	**9**	**3**	**5**	**8**	**6**	**8**	**1**	**2**	**3**

Key: circle 1, triangle 2, square 3, plus 4, cross 5, diamond 6, line 7, V 8, T 9. The symbols appear six or seven times each, and no symbol is ever next to itself.

5. Scoring

- **Parts 1 to 3:** one mark for each correct letter or number; no marks taken away for wrong answers. Raw score out of 12 for each part. Do not combine the three into a total: the parts measure different things and a total hides the profile.
- **Part 4, Processing speed:** the number of boxes **correctly** filled in 90 seconds, maximum 60. A wrong digit, an unreadable digit or an empty box scores 0 for that box; nothing is taken away. Count every box the student filled, including any filled out of order. Write the score as a number out of 60. Also note the number of **errors** (wrong digits) in the profile note if there are more than two: many errors with a high count suggests rushing; few boxes with no errors suggests a slow, careful worker.
- Write the four raw scores on the grading sheet as **Non-verbal / 12, Quantitative / 12, Verbal / 12, Processing speed / 60**. Do not convert them to bands, percentages or ages: there are no norms behind them.
- If a part was not given, or was stopped early, or a student arrived late, write "not given" or "stopped at item 7" rather than a score.

Rough expectations while the school has no reference. From the design of the items, a Year 11 or 12 entrant who reads English at the level the programme needs will usually score **8 or more** on each of Parts 1 to 3, and fill **35 to 50** boxes in Part 4. A Chinese-educated student with limited English will often score as well or better on Parts 1 and 2 and markedly lower on Part 3. These figures are a starting point only; replace them with the school's own reference (Section 6.4) as soon as it exists.

6. Reading the profile

6.1 What the shape means

Read the four scores together with the student's papers, the interview and what the family has told you. Look first at the **shape**: which parts are strong, which are weak **relative to the student's own other parts**, and whether the shape fits the rest of the day. A difference of **3 or more** between two of the parts out of 12 is worth noting; smaller differences are noise.

Profile	What it usually means	Provisional guidance for support planning
Non-verbal and quantitative both 9 or more, verbal low (4 or less, or 3 or more below the others)	Strong reasoning; English is the gap. The verbal items use common words only, so a low score here with strong non-verbal is almost always English, not reasoning.	Plan English support (ESL, reading and vocabulary) rather than learning support. Expect the student's results to rise quickly as their English grows. Say so in the readiness comment.

Profile	What it usually means	Provisional guidance for support planning
All three of Parts 1 to 3 at 4 or less	The student found reasoning with shapes, numbers and words all hard in the time given. This could be ability, anxiety, a misunderstanding of the task, a bad day or a known need.	Do not read it as a verdict. Check that the student understood the task (the practice and examples), look at the maths and science papers and the interview, and **discuss further assessment before a decision** (Admissions Guide Section 9). If the student joins, plan close monitoring in the first term and ask the family about any earlier assessment.
Processing speed well below the others (for example 25 or fewer boxes with Parts 1 to 3 at 8 or more, or a very slow rate with few errors)	The student reasons well but works slowly on a simple paper task. Common causes: reading and writing fluency, carefulness, unfamiliarity with the task, a visual or motor difficulty, or a processing speed difficulty.	**Consider extra time** in school assessments and check **reading fluency** (the sentence reading screen's fluency rating and the reading paper's stopping point). Watch for a student who runs out of time on every paper. If the pattern repeats in the first term, suggest a specialist assessment for access arrangements in public exams.
Strong profile, weak paper results (Parts 1 to 3 at 9 or more, but maths or science bands of 1 or 2, or English well below what the verbal score suggests)	The student can reason but has not learnt, or did not show, the content. Common causes: gaps in prior learning (a different school sequence, a change of school, time out of school), low motivation, or a day that went badly.	**Look for gaps in prior learning** (the NT topics on the grading sheet, the family's account of schooling) **or motivation** (the interview). Plan catch-up in the specific topics rather than general support, and set early targets to check that the student engages.
Quantitative strong, non-verbal weak (3 or more apart)	Comfortable with numbers, less so with visual patterns. Often a well-drilled maths background; sometimes a visual processing issue.	Usually no action. If the student also struggles with diagrams, graphs and geometry on the maths paper, note it for the maths teacher.
Non-verbal strong, quantitative weak (3 or more apart)	Sees patterns in shapes but not in numbers. Often number fluency or confidence; sometimes maths anxiety.	Compare with maths Section A (fluency). Plan number fluency support in maths if the paper agrees.
Even profile, all parts middling (5 to 8 each, Part 4 around 30 to 40)	A typical entrant. Nothing in the screen suggests a particular need.	No action from the screen. Plan from the papers and the interview as usual.
Everything high, Part 4 high (10 or more in each part, 45 or more boxes)	Fast, accurate reasoning across the board.	No support need from the screen. Consider stretch (for example Further Maths or an extra subject) if the papers agree.

6.2 What the screen cannot tell you

- It **cannot diagnose** dyslexia, dyscalculia, ADHD, a processing speed disorder or any other learning difficulty. It can only say "this pattern is worth a closer look". A **specialist assessment** by an educational psychologist or a qualified specialist teacher is needed for a diagnosis and for formal access arrangements in public examinations.
- It **cannot measure intelligence** or potential, and it must not be described to students or families as doing so. Describe it as "a short screen that helps us plan support".
- It **cannot separate** a student's reasoning from their English in Part 3, their attention on the day, their familiarity with this kind of task (students who have practised similar puzzles score higher) or their test anxiety. Part 1 is the most robust to English; none of the parts is robust to a bad day.
- It **cannot be compared with published tests**. A score of 9 out of 12 here means nothing in the terms of any commercial test, and the screen has not been checked for reliability or validity.
- A **single screen cannot track change**. If a student's profile raises a question, the answer comes from watching them learn in the first term, not from giving the screen again.

6.3 Talking to the family

Give the family the plain facts if they ask: the four raw scores, what each part is, and that the screen is for planning support and does not affect the decision. Do not offer an interpretation that sounds like a diagnosis. If the profile suggests a closer look (the second or third rows of the table in 6.1), say that the school would like to understand how the student learns best and ask whether any earlier assessment exists.

6.4 Building the school's own reference

The screen becomes more useful once the school knows what its own entrants typically score.

1. Record every student's four raw scores in the admissions tracker (the Year 11 and Year 12 sheets have columns for them), including students who were not offered a place.
2. After **about 30 students** have taken the screen, work out for each part the **median** and the **lower and upper quartiles** (the 25th and 75th percentile scores). Write them in a short note kept with this guide, with the date and the number of students.
3. From then on, describe each new student's score as "above the upper quartile", "in the middle half" or "below the lower quartile" of the school's own entrants, and use these in place of the fixed numbers in Section 5 and the table in 6.1 (for example "verbal below the lower quartile with non-verbal above the median" is the English-gap profile).
4. Review the reference each year, and separately for Year 11 and Year 12 entrants once each group has about 30 students. If an item is answered correctly by almost everyone or almost no one, or the same wrong answer is chosen by most students, note it in the version register so that the item can be reviewed at the next version.

The reference describes the school's own applicants, who are not a representative population: it supports comparison within the school and nothing more.

7. Recording the result

1. **Mark the booklet** with the answer tables in Section 4. Write the score for each part at its stop banner.
2. **Copy the four raw scores onto the student's grading sheet** (`Y11_Grading_Sheet_v3.1` or `Y12_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) in the cognitive screen rows: **Non-verbal / 12, Quantitative / 12, Verbal / 12, Processing speed / 60**.
3. **Write the profile note** on the line provided: one or two short phrases, naming the shape and the provisional guidance from the table in 6.1, for example "Strong reasoning, English is the gap: ESL support" or "Slow coding (18) with good reasoning: check reading fluency, consider extra time" or "Even profile, no action". Add any known need or arrangement the family has told you about, and anything unusual on the day (anxiety, a misunderstanding of a task, a part not given or stopped early).
4. **Do not** enter the screen in the decision box of the final mark sheet. The final mark sheet carries the four scores and the profile note for the support plan only, marked "for planning support, never for selection".
5. **Enter the four scores in the tracker** so that the school's reference can be built (Section 6.4).
6. **File the marked booklet** with the student's other papers, or shred it under the school's policy.